10 LAWS OF

ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE

Student's #1 Guide For Personal and Academic Excellence

FIFTH EDITION

TOLULOPE AHMED

Foreword by Adeolu Akinyemi

TOLULOPE AHMED

Popularly known as **Dr. Tee**, Tolulope is a first-class graduate of Engineering Physics with the highest CGPA in the faculty of Science, Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, Osun State (2009/2010).

He holds an MSc. in Physics from University of Lagos (UNILAG), and an Executive Masters of Business Administration, (EMBA) from Quantic School of Business & Technology, Washington DC, USA.

Dr. Tee has helped over 400,000 people achieve excellent academic results, authored 6 books (including the **9 Steps to Financial Freedom**), created 2 textbooks, 2 educational games for Secondary Schools. And has won over 21 awards in cooperate Nigeria and academia.

He is the Chief Publisher at **ValuePlus Publishing**, Lagos. and the CEO/Co-founder of **MyFund**, a fintech platform that helps working-class, retiring population and people abroad people save towards owning properties for a lifetime rental income at **www.myfundmobile.com**, in Lagos, Nigeria.

About the Book

"I finally saw my results and I had all As (5.00GPA) in my 400L and graduated with 4.53/5.00 (first-class) to the glory of God in 2023. Thank you so much sir, 10 Laws of Academic Excellence really transformed me." — **ENIOLA OBITOPE, CALEB UNIVERSITY (2023).**

"From Failure in Industrial Chemistry at OAU to getting a meritorious award for the Academia of the Year by my department (Microbiology) in 100 Level in FUOYE, it's really a joy to have something valuable that you've created, sir." — **RIDWAN ADEBISI, FUOYE (2022).**

"A friend sold this book to me and it got my attention as soon as I started using it, guiding me to ultimately finish with first class (Microbiology)." — **DEBORAH BELLO, BOWEN (2019).**

"I and a friend contributed money to buy 1 copy of this book at our freshers' programme. It was my secret to graduating as the first first-class graduate in 35+ years of Political Science at the Lagos State University." — **DAVID OLUSANJO, LASU (2018).**

"For over 12 years people asked me the most important law of Academic Excellence, I always said there's not just one. But over the years, I've tried to summarize it in this one essential statement, ***'document solutions to past/likely questions throughout the semester for you to practice/review them for exam.'*** This habit is perhaps the central pillar of this book." — **AUTHOR**

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10 Laws of Academic Excellence

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Genre: Self-help, Personal Success.

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Endorsements

WHAT OTHERS ARE SAYING **ABOUT THIS BOOK**

"If you need a book to evenly deliver to you the secrets for not just success in academic pursuit but in life, then you are holding one in your hand. Pragmatically written and patterned, it's filled with deep insights to put you ahead. You should read this book!"— **Adedeji Adeshina,**

First-class graduate, OAU, Ile-Ife; and
Regional Director of Enrollment - MEA at Hult International Business School, Dubai

"Great book, worth reading, well spelt out principles, articulated in such a way that one big concept of understanding is ministered to people. Shalom!"
— **Segun Obadje PhD.,**

First-class graduate and lecturer, Building department, OAU; and
Senior Pastor, God's Love Tabernacle International Church, worldwide.

"I came to OAU in 2007 (Physics Dept.) In my 200L, I met the only first-class student in 300L—Tolulope Ahmed. I chose him as my academic mentor. He taught me the basic principles of Academic Excellence. Going through that process, I had 90As and several 80's. Ultimately, I graduated with a first class in the same department in 2012. I advise you reader to apply the principles in this book prayerfully and you'll sure get what you desire!" — **Ayodeji Ibitoye PhD.,**

First-class graduate, Physics Department, Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife. (2012)

"Jesus said, 'Behold, I give unto you, ***keys****…' This book is potent with divine and practical wisdom keys that unravel EVERY mystery behind how to become a scholar. My heart leaps for joy because, alas; our younger generation will no longer be a victim of academic wreckage. Bro. Tolulope, a job WELL done!"*

— **Olumide Olujuyigbe,**

Lead Architect and Project manager at Mightymee Shelter solutions

"This is a must-read for students & career people. It's a quintessential, based on genuine practical experience. It's a sure guide to academic success. This is real! Give it a trial and you are sure to be an epitome of excellence."— **Tunde Aroyehun,**

Lead Pastor, Living Epistles Family Church, Ajegunle, Lagos.

"10 ABSOLUTELY UNBREAKABLE LAWS OF ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE comes highly recommended. Inspiring, practical and easy to read... every student with a desire for academic prowess should master Tolulope Ahmed's tested and proven principles!"

— **Olaolu Oluwadare,**

Senior Pastor, God's Love Tabernacle International Church, Ile-Ife.

"This is a compendium of nuggets that would help any reader achieve inevitable academic success; and turn people into high flyers in any chosen endeavour/career." — **Dennis Imafidon,**

CEO, Apex Tutors

"Great teachers inspire because it is their divine ability. Tolulope Ahmed is a living testimony of Academic EXPLOITS and this book will cause the radical change you have been waiting for! Put the 10 laws to the test!"

— **Moses Ojo,**

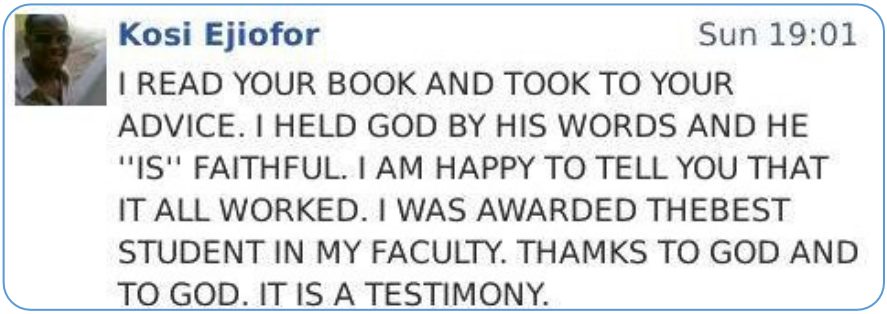
Lawyer, Resident Pastor, Gospel Faith Mission Int'l, Ketu District H/Q Lagos.

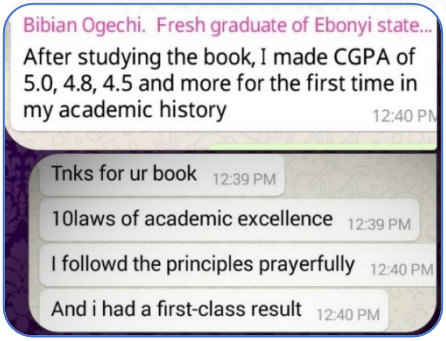
"When I came into OAU Physics Dept, I was determined to beat the best graduating student's record. In part 1, I had a strong second-class upper. But learning and applying these principles, I thank God I eventually graduated with first class."

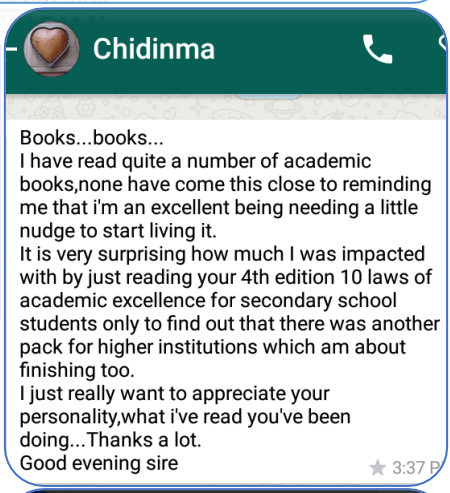
— **Isaac Oguntoye PhD.,**

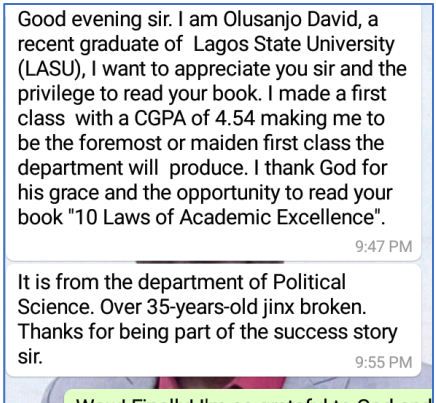
First-class graduate, Physics Department, Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife. (2013), Graduate Research Assistant (Photonics Materials and Devices Laboratory), Tulane University, US.

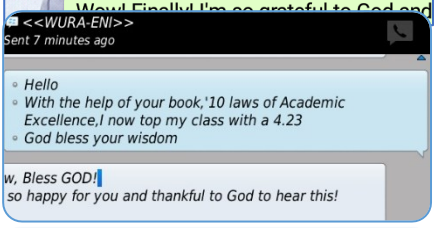
FEEDBACK AND TESTIMONIES OF **CHANGED LIVES**

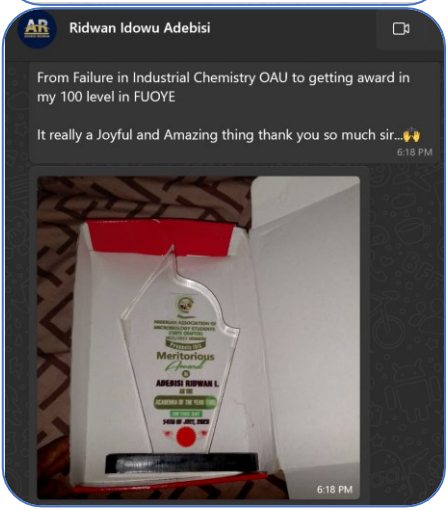


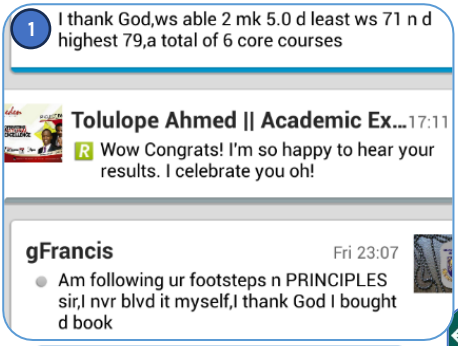


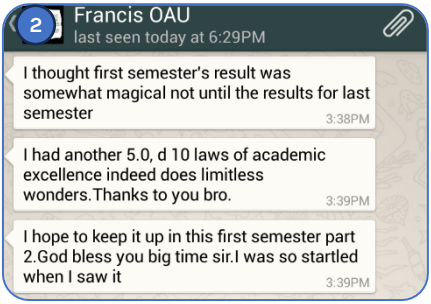


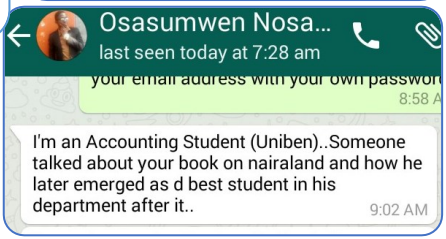


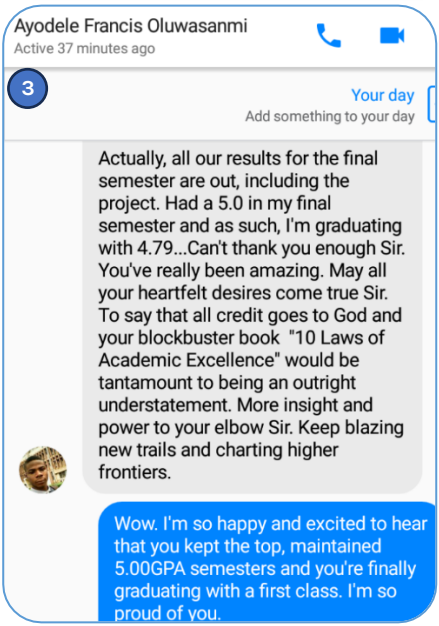


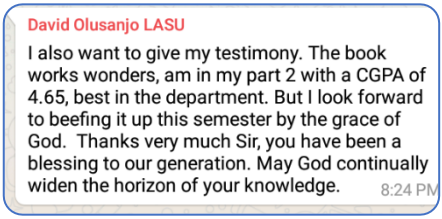


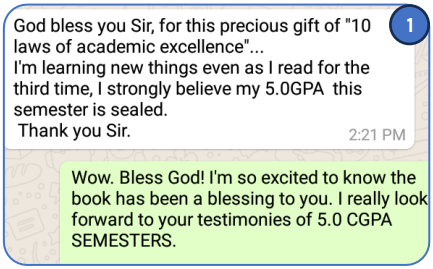

1
I thank God,ws able 2 mk 5.0 d least ws 71 n d highest 79,a total of 6 core courses
Tolulope Ahmed || Academic Ex...17:11
Wow Congrats! I'm so happy to hear your results. I celebrate you oh!
gFrancis
Fri 23:07
Am following ur footsteps n PRINCIPLES sir,I nvr blvd it myself,I thank God I bought d book

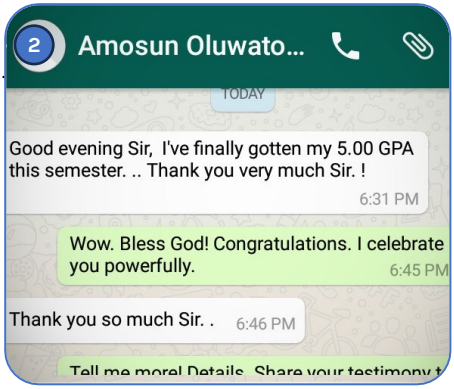

2
Francis OAU
last seen today at 6:29PM
I thought first semester's result was somewhat magical not until the results for last semester
3:38PM
I had another 5.0, d 10 laws of academic excellence indeed does limitless wonders.Thanks to you bro.
3:39PM
I hope to keep it up in this first semester part 2.God bless you big time sir.I was so startled when I saw it
3:39PM

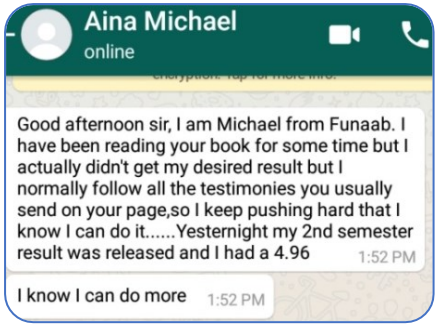

Osasumwen Nosa...
last seen today at 7:28 am
8:58 A
I'm an Accounting Student (Uniben)..Someone talked about your book on nairaland and how he later emerged as d best student in his department after it..
9:02 AM

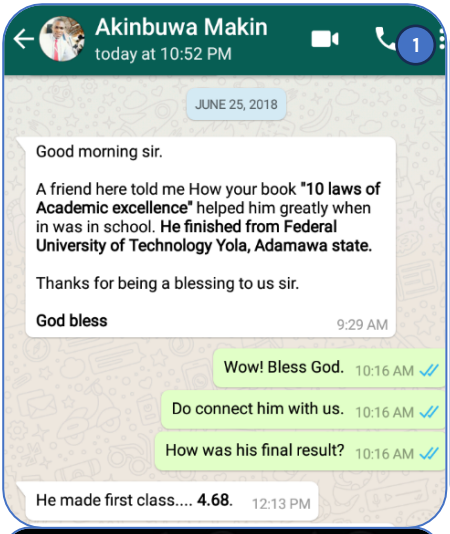

Ayodele Francis Oluwasanmi
Active 37 minutes ago
3
Your day
Add something to your day
Actually, all our results for the final semester are out, including the project. Had a 5.0 in my final semester and as such, I'm graduating with 4.79...Can't thank you enough Sir. You've really been amazing. May all your heartfelt desires come true Sir. To say that all credit goes to God and your blockbuster book "10 Laws of Academic Excellence" would be tantamount to being an outright understatement. More insight and power to your elbow Sir. Keep blazing new trails and charting higher frontiers.
Wow. I'm so happy and excited to hear that you kept the top, maintained 5.00GPA semesters and you're finally graduating with a first class. I'm so proud of you.

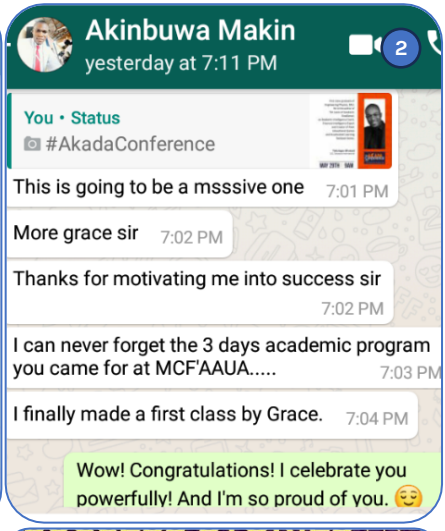

David Olusanjo LASU
I also want to give my testimony. The book works wonders, am in my part 2 with a CGPA of 4.65, best in the department. But I look forward to beefing it up this semester by the grace of God. Thanks very much Sir, you have been a blessing to our generation. May God continually widen the horizon of your knowledge.
8:24 PM

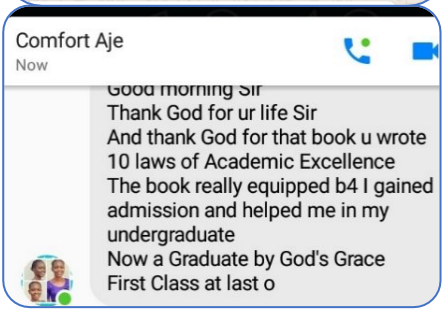

1
God bless you Sir, for this precious gift of "10 laws of academic excellence"...
I'm learning new things even as I read for the third time, I strongly believe my 5.0GPA this semester is sealed.
Thank you Sir.
2:21 PM
Wow. Bless God! I'm so excited to know the book has been a blessing to you. I really look forward to your testimonies of 5.0 CGPA SEMESTERS.

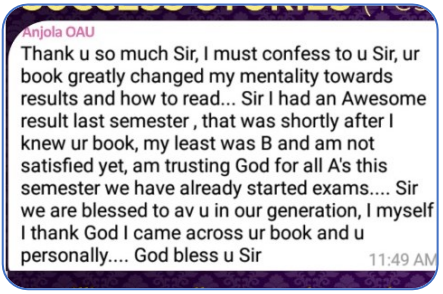

2
Amosun Oluwato...
TODAY
Good evening Sir, I've finally gotten my 5.00 GPA this semester. .. Thank you very much Sir. !
6:31 PM
Wow. Bless God! Congratulations. I celebrate you powerfully.
6:45 PM
Thank you so much Sir. .
6:46 PM

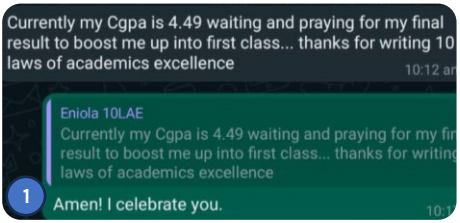

Aina Michael
online
Good afternoon sir, I am Michael from Funaab. I have been reading your book for some time but I actually didn't get my desired result but I normally follow all the testimonies you usually send on your page,so I keep pushing hard that I know I can do it.....Yesternight my 2nd semester result was released and I had a 4.96
1:52 PM
I know I can do more
1:52 PM

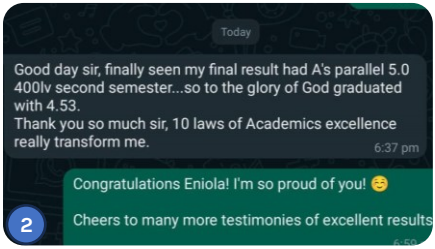

Akinbuwa Makin
today at 10:52 PM
1
JUNE 25, 2018
Good morning sir.
A friend here told me How your book "10 laws of Academic excellence" helped him greatly when in was in school. He finished from Federal University of Technology Yola, Adamawa state.
Thanks for being a blessing to us sir.
God bless
9:29 AM
Wow! Bless God. 10:16 AM
Do connect him with us. 10:16 AM
How was his final result? 10:16 AM
He made first class.... 4.68. 12:13 PM

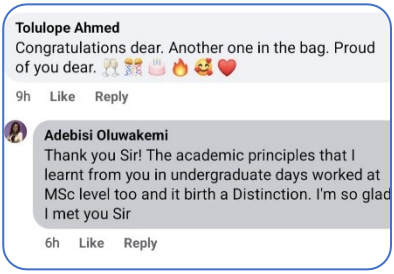

Akinbuwa Makin
yesterday at 7:11 PM
2
You • Status
#AkadaConference
This is going to be a msssive one 7:01 PM
More grace sir 7:02 PM
Thanks for motivating me into success sir 7:02 PM
I can never forget the 3 days academic program you came for at MCF'AAUA..... 7:03 PM
I finally made a first class by Grace. 7:04 PM
Wow! Congratulations! I celebrate you powerfully! And I'm so proud of you.

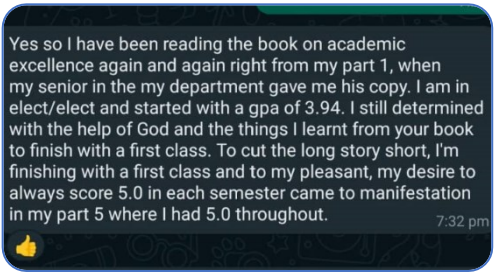

Comfort Aje
Now
Good morning Sir
Thank God for ur life Sir
And thank God for that book u wrote
10 laws of Academic Excellence
The book really equipped b4 I gained admission and helped me in my undergraduate
Now a Graduate by God's Grace
First Class at last o

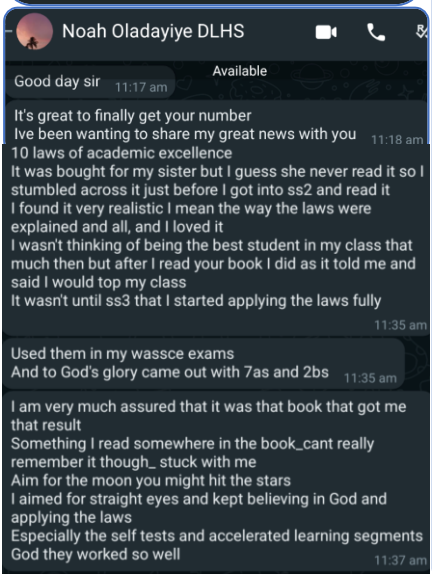

Anjola OAU
Thank u so much Sir, I must confess to u Sir, ur book greatly changed my mentality towards results and how to read... Sir I had an Awesome result last semester , that was shortly after I knew ur book, my least was B and am not satisfied yet, am trusting God for all A's this semester we have already started exams.... Sir we are blessed to av u in our generation, I myself I thank God I came across ur book and u personally.... God bless u Sir
11:49 AM

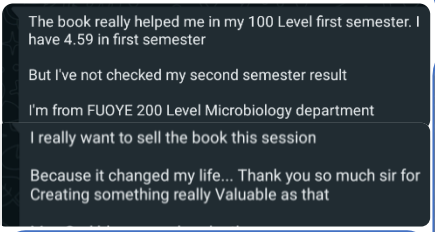

Currently my Cgpa is 4.49 waiting and praying for my final result to boost me up into first class... thanks for writing 10 laws of academics excellence
10:12 ar
Eniola 10LAE
Currently my Cgpa is 4.49 waiting and praying for my fir result to boost me up into first class... thanks for writing laws of academics excellence
1
Amen! I celebrate you.


Today
Good day sir, finally seen my final result had A's parallel 5.0 400lv second semester...so to the glory of God graduated with 4.53.
Thank you so much sir, 10 laws of Academics excellence really transform me.
6:37 pm
Congratulations Eniola! I'm so proud of you!
Cheers to many more testimonies of excellent results
2


Tolulope Ahmed
Congratulations dear. Another one in the bag. Proud of you dear.
9h Like Reply
Adebisi Oluwakemi
Thank you Sir! The academic principles that I learnt from you in undergraduate days worked at MSc level too and it birth a Distinction. I'm so glad I met you Sir
6h Like Reply

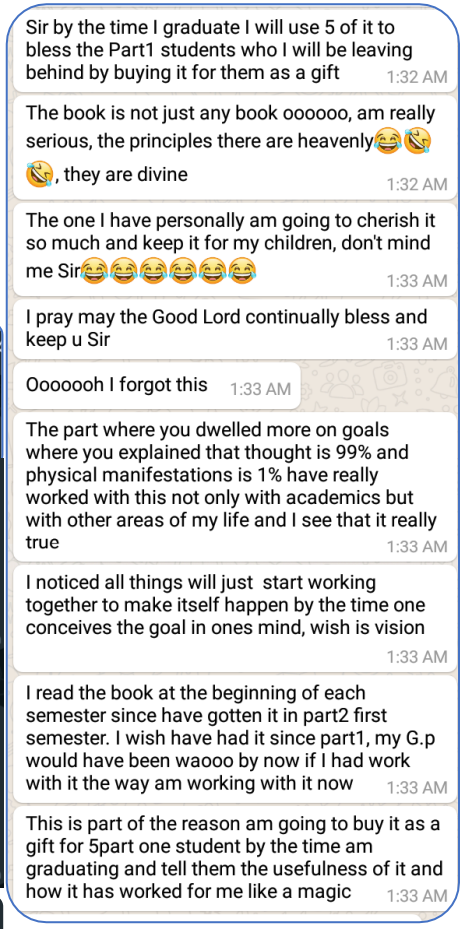

Yes so I have been reading the book on academic excellence again and again right from my part 1, when my senior in the my department gave me his copy. I am in elect/elect and started with a gpa of 3.94. I still determined with the help of God and the things I learnt from your book to finish with a first class. To cut the long story short, I'm finishing with a first class and to my pleasant, my desire to always score 5.0 in each semester came to manifestation in my part 5 where I had 5.0 throughout.
7:32 pm

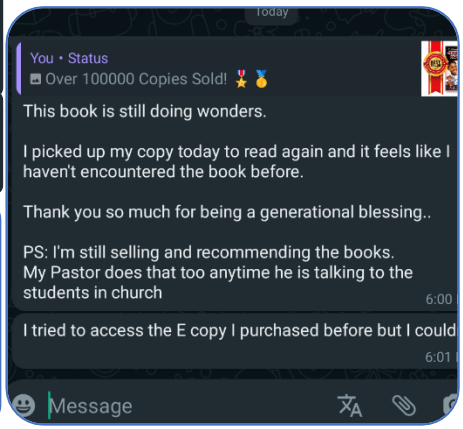




*"Sir, last year, you told me to dream of scoring **400/400** in UTME. I have never heard anyone dream that big or talk that way before. This infused a force into me, that I scored 284/400 despite the mass failure, I even got **96% in Physics**, because the **SELF-TESTS** method you gave me drove me to do extra study in Physics."*

— **BIODUN ILESANMI**, OAU (2014)





Acknowledgements

IN THE LAST 12 YEARS, I HAVE RECEIVED AMAZING FEEDBACK AND testimonies of changed lives that have stunned me! I've received over 13 different awards on Academic Excellence from different organizations for helping students (and the youth) across the country achieve personal and academic excellence.

I've seen hundreds of people who have salvaged their bad academic records, scores who have received awards, several who have won grants and scholarships, travelled abroad for their master's and doctorate degrees and launched into amazing careers! It has really been very heart-warming!

I want to appreciate all those who have contributed to the creation of this book and these amazing lives that have been changed and many more lives to touch.

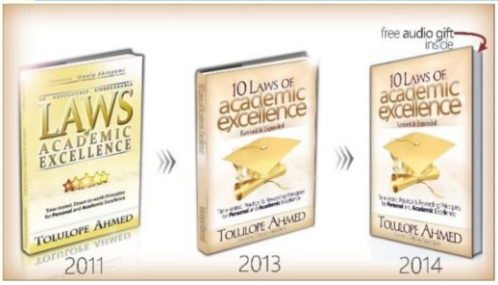
I thank my parents, mentors, friends and many of the students whose feedback has inspired this revised and expanded edition.

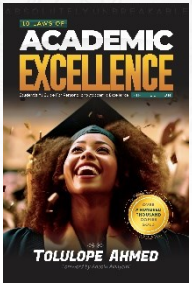
God, I thank You for giving me the inspiration, courage, and guidance for the effective completion of this amazing work. God, make everyone reading this book experience personal and academic excellence!

Tolulope Ahmed
Author; CEO/Co-founder, MyFund
January 2024.

The Fifth Edition

WHAT'S **NEW?**





THE FIRST EDITION OF THIS BOOK WAS RELEASED IN MARCH 2011 and as you know, we've sold over 100,000 copies and received a lot of stunning "feedback" from seminars, in the form of questions, testimonials, awards and excellent academic results. And I've also had to help people handle their academic challenges in the process of applying the Laws.

Two Main Reason for This FIFTH Edition

1. I see this book as an *ongoing communication* with my students, and
2. To effectively meet the needs of the *feedback* I've received in the last 12 years.

What's New?

1. **Everything in the Fourth Edition**, including The Laws Redefined, FAQs, Review Questions, Testimonials, bonus audios and videos.
2. **How to Leverage Generative AI** for Academic Excellence.

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www.youtube.com/tolulopeahmed (videos)

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LAW...

#1. **ACADEMIC GOAL** — 1
(How to Set Your Academic Goal and Start Attracting Academic Excellence)

#2. **SELF-DISCOVERY** — 12
(How to stop being an average student and start getting excellent results)

#3. **POSITIVE LEARNING ATTITUDE** — 22
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#5. **TIME MANAGEMENT** — 33
(How to convert time into virtues and always have a fulfilling day)

#6. **DILIGENCE** — 46
(How to develop yourself so fast that you may even outgrow your age in maturity)

#7. **PAST QUESTIONS** — 51
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#8. **ACCELERATED LEARNING** — 60
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Foreword

THERE ARE TWO WAYS TO GET TO a desired end in life—*you can either create a new path for yourself or follow a path that has already been charted successfully by great people*. If academic excellence is your desire, there is no need to reinvent the wheels; Tolulope's masterpiece gives you the keys.

Tolulope walks his talk! He shares in this book principles he has tested successfully, and if they are true for him, they can be true for all. He has handled and tested them in one of the most difficult environments in Nigeria, and taught them to others with amazing results and testimonies of changed lives.

With unreserved commitments to applying these time-proven principles, he bagged a first-class (honours) from the university—and has helped many people achieve the same. You can achieve the same as well!

I approve, recommend and compel you to get a copy and recommend it to your friends!

Adeolu Akinyemi

Adeolu Akinyemi,
MD/CEO Avenues to Wealth (A2W), West Africa;
Pastor, Heaven's Citizens Christian Center.

WHAT **IS...**

Academic Intelligence?

BE SURE THAT YOU HAVE A GENUINE DESIRE FOR ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE before reading this book. The test of that is to promise yourself ahead that you're going to do the things suggested in this book.

This book contains "**Laws**" *(of Academic Excellence)*. Laws are *no respecter of persons*. They work, whether you believe or understand them or not. Just like gravity affects you whether you know how it works or not. And how if you *mistakenly* touch a naked wire, it will shock you first! Laws work! They have to. They work, period. That's why they're called *laws*. All you need is to learn, apply and work with *(and not against)* them.

I predict that somewhere between your **4th** and **100th** reading, the spirit of the book (and of the author) will enter into you; and yield excellent results in your life and academics, like it has done for many. When this happens, recommend or bless others with copies of this book.

What's Academic Intelligence?

*"Academic Intelligence" is "that part of our total intelligence that we use to solve academic problems... **towards academic excellence!**" (see picture).*

So, if a student is always answering questions all the time so that he can eventually score 100% in all his courses, he is academically intelligent.

But when a student is not making the extra effort to always score 100%, he is not academically intelligent.

Not a Magic Formula!

This book is designed to take you through a process—a process of solving academic challenges which develops your academic intelligence… which ultimately leads to excellent grades. It is not a get-result-fast book (or a book about some magic formula). It is not a book you read and absorb once. It was not written to increase your level of knowledge only. Ah! Yes, in the study of this book, you are actually attempting to positively *change* your thinking, your habits, your words, your actions and your way of life.

There are 3 fundamental steps: READ, REVIEW and APPLY (over and over again) until you become very competent. This process takes time, persistence and daily application. But undoubtedly, you will see the positive results in your life. In fact,

> *The total summary of this book is **not** to give you a shortcut, but to take you through a **process** such that you get to a point where you are excellent at what you do—and **you know** that you're excellent at it! Not by pride but because you know that you have paid the price.*

Practicing What I Preach

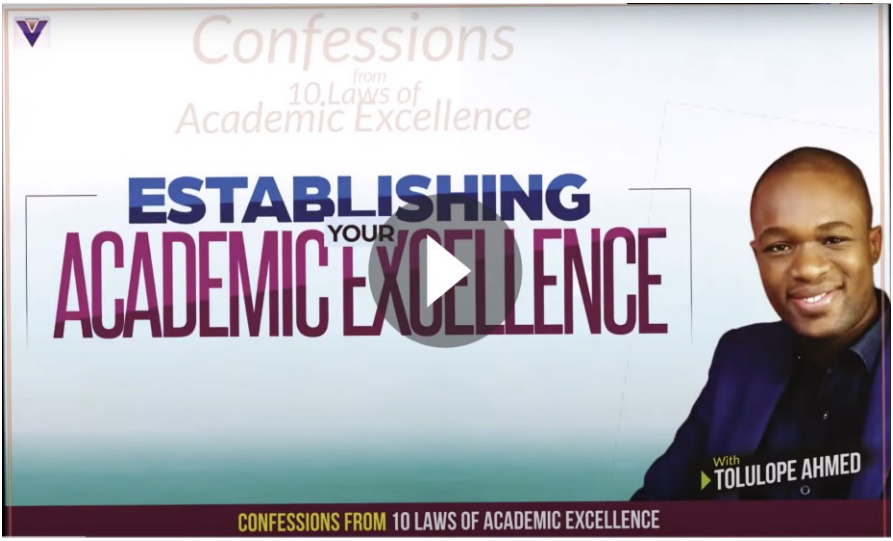
I only teach what I've achieved and help people achieve. I say this because I know I can't give what I don't have. I can only raise you to my level of results (and not my level of knowledge). This does not mean that you have to do exactly what I did, nor that all the methods in this book will work for you exactly as they worked for me. The methods can change, but the principles don't! In the last decade, hundreds of thousands of people have achieved *100% scores/GPA, First-class, Best in Department, Best in*

Faculty, etc.; thousands have leveraged their results to win *awards, grants, fellowships* and *full scholarships* for masters and PhDs in several countries around the world. And so can you!

I also know that I don't have all the answers. This FIFTH EDITION is proof of that. I simply want to share with you my experiences — a journey of academic excellence I've gone through and also taken other people through to achieve what they achieved. I share with you what we've learned, experienced and taught, with the intent that it will help you achieve the same.

Establishing Your Academic Excellence *(Bonus Video)*

Watch and practice saying the contents in this video titled "*Establishing Your Academic Excellence*" to develop the mindset of the students of this book. You'll start seeing the results too when the spirit of the book/author enters into you.



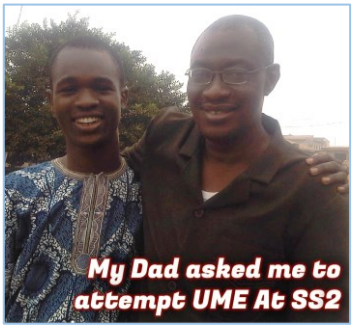
Watch the video at…

> *https://bit.ly/10lawsEstablish*

HOW I STARTED **GETTING**

Excellent Results – My Story

I WASN'T VERY BRILLIANT FROM CHILDHOOD. I STRUGGLED TO PASS MY exams. I left primary school in year 4 and went directly into high school (*without doing common entrance*). Again, without doing Junior **WAEC***, I changed schools and went straight to year SS1 (year 10) where I was the only Science student in the school! My class was *one bench* that contained SS1 and on the other side was *another bench* that contained SS2. This was where and when my dad (of blessed memory) **challenged** me to attempt UTME at SS2 (not SS3).



So, I Became VERY SERIOUS!

This challenge was the beginning of my personal discipline and personal development for me. I didn't want to fail the UTME and I didn't want to fail my dad either; so, I developed a commitment to PERSONAL TRAINING. I began to teach myself several topics in my subjects. "Break times" were "study times" for me. In no time, *I attracted the attention of some of my teachers*. I told them my goal was to pass the JAMB exam at SS2, and they gave me personal development books that could help me achieve my goal.

> *Once you're in motion towards a goal, unseen forces will come to your aid.*

Then I Discovered TWO Principles

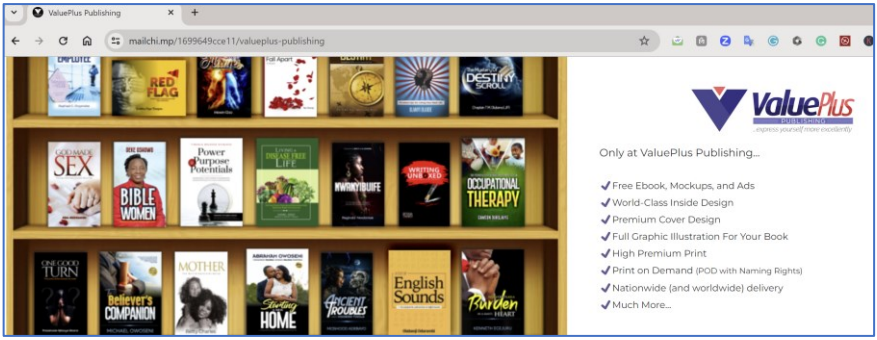
#1. If you can read, write and understand, you can teach yourself anything.

#2. If you're waiting for people to teach you everything, there's a high chance that you'll wait in vain; and you might end up not learning anything. Therefore, TEACH YOURSELF! Develop yourself!

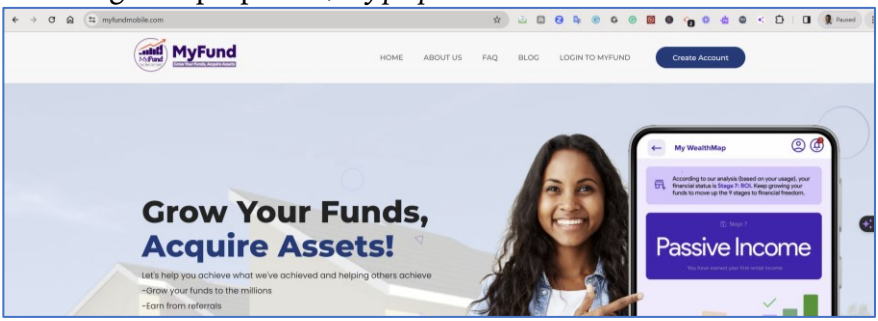
The Results?

Today, I've continuously applied these two principles to achieve a lot:

#1. I studied many eBooks (and now **coursera.org** courses) to learn product design and consequently built **ValuePlus Publishing** with 1000+ titles published and counting (including the book you're holding right now).



#2. I learnt typing (now 100 words per minute) by practising over and over on my own (using Mavis Beacon Typing Software), followed it up with coding, front-end, backend, full-stack development, DevOps and built **MyFund** (www.myfundmobile.com), a fintech company that helps working-class people *save, buy properties* and *earn rent* for life.



#3. I also learnt how to speak French by spending years on Duolingo and listening to French podcasts on my own [without going to a French School]. And I will still learn Chinese, and many other languages.

You can do the same as well!

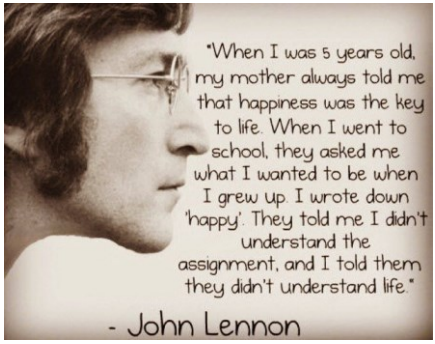
> *"If you can read, write and understand, you can teach yourself anything!"*

How I Started Getting Excellent Results

I later passed my JAMB exams [at SS2]. Though I had no A nor B at O' Level I had all **C**s), I went on to the prestigious Obafemi Awolowo University, Osun State; where I continued applying these laws and kept getting excellent grades until I graduated with a first-class degree—the best student in Faculty of Science. As one of my mentors once said…

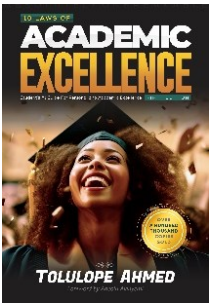
> *"The day I started getting excellent grades was not the day I fell and hit my head in the correct place. It was the day I discovered I'm **supposed** to be the best!"*

Decide What You Want to Be!



Do you have a dream of having 100% in all your courses? Do you want to break records in your school and set new ones? Do you want to win competitions, scholarships, etc.? Or make your first million before graduation? Then, DECIDE and others will support you!

More About This Book



This book holds a biblical worldview. I aim to be relevant and revealing regardless of what your worldview is. But because I view life through my Christian Faith, I realize that these teachings are consistent with biblical principles. While I do not quote heavily from scriptures, I do reference it as the guidebook to make the most of this book.

First, Write Down What You Want to Achieve

> *"By writing down your dreams and goals on paper, **you set in motion** the process of achieving it." — Mark Victor Hansen*

Your mentor can only help you achieve YOUR OWN GOALS, not his goals for you. This is because ***you cannot experience a future YOU cannot see!*** So, write down your goal. Millions of people pray for the next level without a picture of what that next level looks like in their minds, how sad!

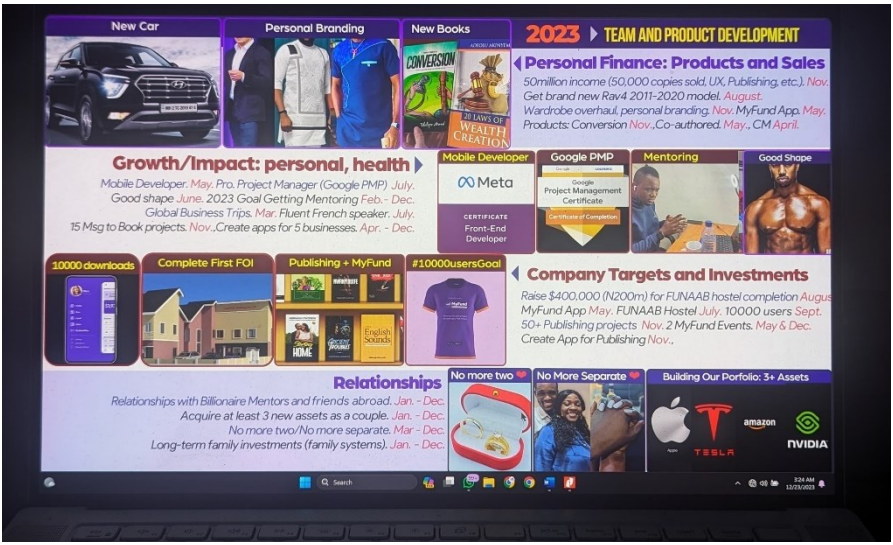
Stop reading for a moment and imagine what it looks like at your graduation as the best. Get a book (not a sheet of paper), write on the first page, "*Goals for Academics",* and describe it, for example *(fill and include the year)* …

- ✓ First-class *(Honours)* graduate of _____
- ✓ Most Versatile Personality (MVP) of the Year Award, _____
- ✓ 100% Record in _____ for answering ALL the questions.
- ✓ New Record or High Score in _____
- ✓ Win ___ scholarships/grants _____
- ✓ _____

Place Your Goals Where You Can Always See Them

> *"Once you've decided to do something important, you need to deliberately surround yourself with things that will remind you of it every single day!"*

Put your goals on the walls of your room, the background display of your phone/laptop, the first page of your notes, the top edges of the pages of your book, the front door of your refrigerator, vision board, etc. e.g., my goals for the year are always at the background display of my laptop.



To my Goal Template to prepare yours, go to **http://bit.ly/DrTeeVisionBoard**

Things You Should Achieve Before Graduation

With your academic goals, I recommend you achieve the following 7 *sample goals* as well. (You may start by reading or taking courses on them).

1. Ability to hear God for divine direction *(it gets better with practice)*
2. At least **20 certifications** in skill development *(comes by practice)*
3. Professional **Tech** skills *(typing, Social Media leverage, etc.)*

4. **Selling** Skills — At least **1 million** in savings/investments
5. **Leadership** (and communication) skills *(volunteer for positions)*
6. **Get a Remote Job** before graduation.
7. An extra **language** *(for international opportunities)*

Perhaps the 3 most basic skills for the new economy to develop are *tech*, *selling* and *leadership* skills.

So, What Do You Want to Achieve Before Graduation?

*Write it based on **the future**—based on what you're willing **to work hard to get**.*

_____

_____

_____

Listen, as you meditate and work on these goals daily, your life gets ***readjusted*** into the same goal until you achieve it (LAW 1). If by reading these ***sample*** goals, they seem too high for you, then maybe you are not ready for this book yet. But by going through the pages ahead, the principles in this book would help you to achieve these goals and other goals of yours.

People will call you a genius, miraculous, or spectacular and so on; those are the words that they have fashioned to explain things that they don't understand. But you will understand these things (principles) by reading this book and will produce excellent results like many others have done.

Now, if you are ready, let's begin!

"The 4 Basic Concepts"

HOW TO **MASTER ANYTHING!**

IF ALL YOU MASTER IN THIS BOOK ARE THESE 4 CONCEPTS, YOU CAN achieve success in anything in life — including academics. They are…

#1. Who Should You Listen To?
#2. Your Teachability Index
#3. The Training Balance Scale.
#4. The 4 Steps of Learning.

#1. WHO SHOULD YOU LISTEN TO?

You should *only* listen to (or learn from) the people who *already* have in their lives what you desire.

No one can raise you to his level of knowledge; only to their level of **results** (or **experience**). This is *mentoring*! If you cannot see clearly what you desire in the life of who is teaching you, don't listen to him (he can't help you). Next time, you won't just read books because of their "titles", or listen to a speaker/author because he spoke well about it—except he already lives what he teaches.

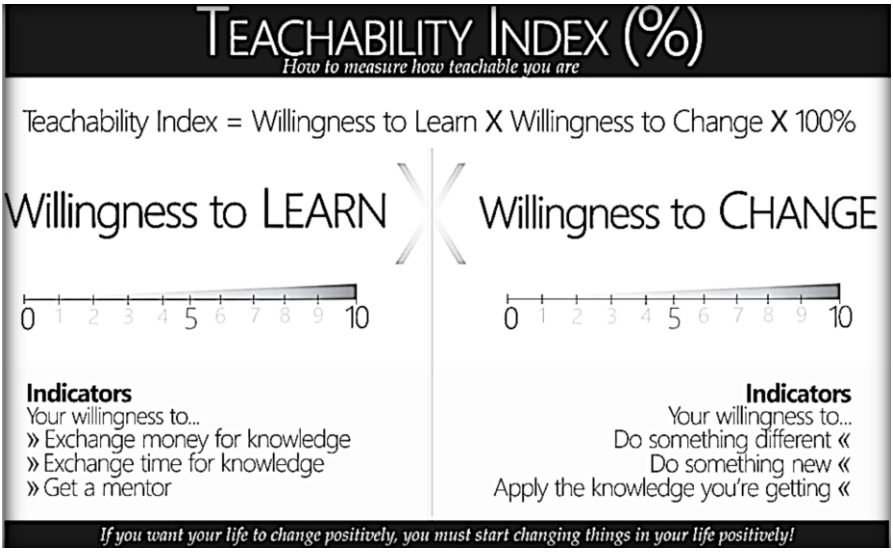
For authors/speakers, the rule is this: *"If you want to write a book about success, you should already be successful. If you want to write a book on marriage, you should already have a model marriage. If you want to teach about academic excellence, you should already be academically excellent!"* Why? Because you cannot give what you don't have.

If your mentor already walks his talk, then go on to basic concept #2.

#2. YOUR TEACHABILITY INDEX

This is a measure of how teachable you are. It has two parts…

#1. Your Willingness to Learn (WTL)
#2. Your Willingness to Change (WTC)



Scientific research has shown that…

> *"The less you learn, the more you think you know. But the more you learn, the more you REALIZE that there is even more to know."*

I tell people, *"Willingness to Learn (WTL) is very easy,"* the mere fact that you're reading this book is an indication that you're willing to learn. *Willingness to Change (WTC)* however is where most people fail. WTC is your willingness to DO what you're "learning" (from those who already have in their lives, what you desire), regardless of whether it contradicts your feelings, previous knowledge/experience or former way of doing things.

So, What's Your Teachability Index?

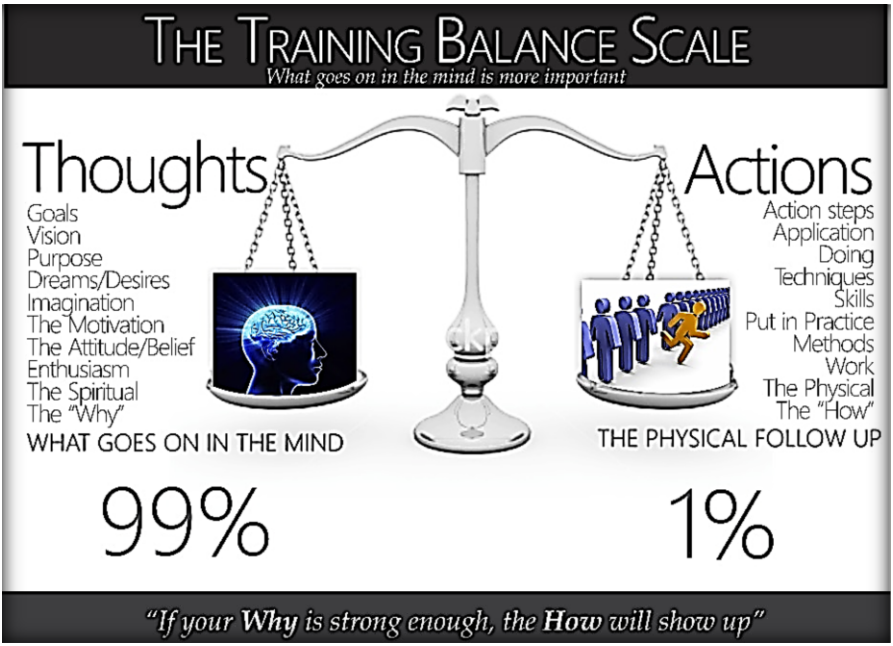
$$\text{Teachability Index } (100\%) = (WTL) \times (WTC) \times 100\%$$

In summary, the Teachability Index teaches you to become obsessed with LEARNING (from people who already have what you desire) and to constantly keep DOING things you couldn't do so that you can become competent at doing them!

> *"If you want your life to change positively, you need to start changing things in your life positively!"*

#3. THE TRAINING BALANCE SCALE

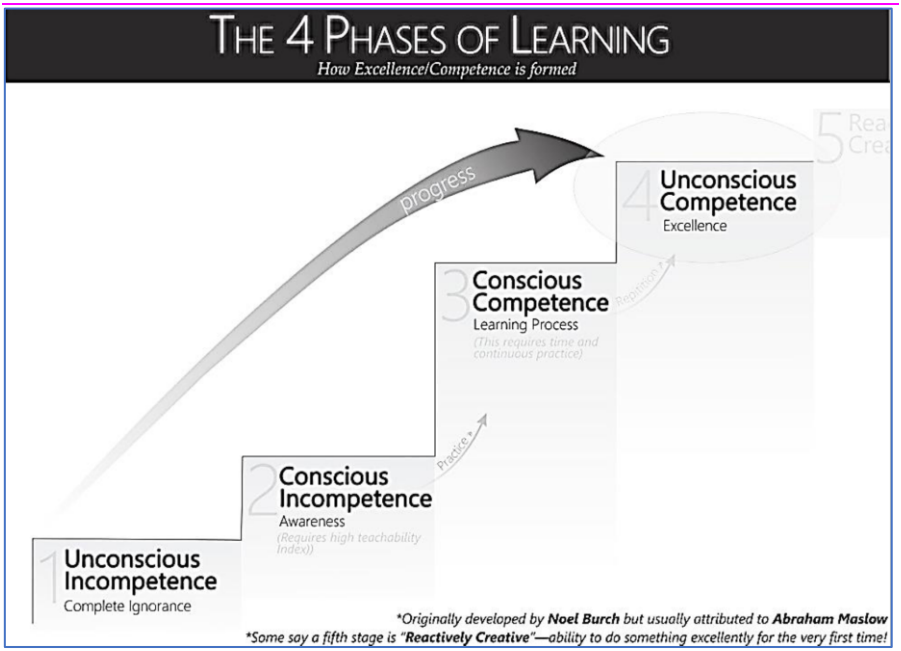
What goes on in the mind is far more important than the action. If "what goes on in the mind" is accurate and strong enough (99%), the "actions" will simply be a "Physical Follow-up" (or the correct actions will seem to suggest themselves to you). They say it this way:



> *If the "why" is strong enough, the "how" will show up.*

The way to know if your why is strong enough is when your goal is so clear in your mind that you find yourself thinking and talking about achieving that goal most of the time. Research shows that when you think and talk about your goals most of the time, events and circumstances will '*rearrange*' themselves to ensure the goal is achieved. A mechanism in the brain called the *Reticular Activating System (RAS)* starts to filter the necessary information/circumstances into your attention.

#4. THE FOUR STEPS OF LEARNING



This is how '*excellence*' is formed.

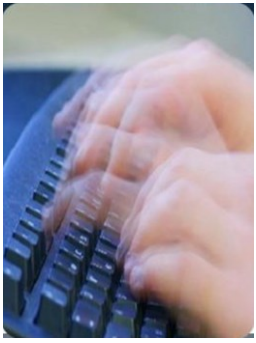
1. **Unconscious Incompetence**: ("I don't even know what I don't know how to do.") Here, you are not even aware you don't know how to do something.

You are not conscious that you are not competent. For example, you are probably not *consciously aware* that you don't yet know how to **type** fast (or drive a car, etc.). But now that I mentioned it, you've become aware. If you're also *willing to learn,* then you have moved to stage 2.

2. **Conscious Incompetence:** ("Oh, it's true, I don't know how to do that yet."). Here, you are conscious of your incompetence. This is where your teachability index kicks in! You realize you don't know it ***yet***, and are *probably* teachable—willing to learn and do something different to get it. For example, you're ready to register and start practising—stage 3.

3. **Conscious Competence:** ("Now, I'm doing it and I think I'm getting it gradually.") Here, the REAL WORK BEGINS. To be at step 3, you simply need to *practice, practice, practice*. After consistent practice, you are **able** to **type** but still need to think about how your hands are pressing each key. The key question is: "How do you move from this to the final stage of learning?" *Repetition, repetition, repetition!* You keep typing and typing and typing until one day, something magical happens… you find yourself typing without even thinking about it.

4. **Unconscious Competence:** ("What? I did it perfectly? I wasn't even thinking it.") Here, you are doing it perfectly without thinking about it. You can even be doing it while doing something else. E.g., we tie our shoelaces, speak a language, etc. without thinking.



You see, this *unconscious competence* stage is what is called "***excellence***" *(or "expert", "skilled", "guru", "autopilot", or "habit")*

These are words many people will use to describe you when they don't understand the process you've gone through.

> *"It takes **a lot of practice** to become EXCELLENT."*

LAW **#1**

Academic Goal

"You can ONLY experience a future result you can see!"

*"If **you talk in terms of your result most of the time**, things will work together academically to make it happen."*

THE STARTING POINT OF EVERY SUCCESS FORMULA IN THE world is ***having a goal.*** Even the dictionary defines 'Success' as ***"the achievement of a goal."*** When God wants to change your life, academics or even a nation, the first thing He gives you is a *vision—a mental picture of your preferred futures*

> ***Over 95%*** *of students don't have academic goals. Not you! At the end of this chapter, you would have separated yourself from those 95% of students.*

Begin With the End in Mind

"There is nothing more irritating as continuing on a path in which you have no idea how it will end". Jesus said, *"How many of you who want to build a house will not sit down first and count the cost to know if you're able to finish*

it."[1] If you go into your academics without a clear goal, you will end up in the crowd (the 95%) as average. But once you set your goal, you have distinguished yourself from the crowd.

> *"Until you know very clearly your ACADEMIC RESULTS (or CGPA) at the end of the semester, you are not qualified to begin that semester."*

Everything in the World is Created Twice!

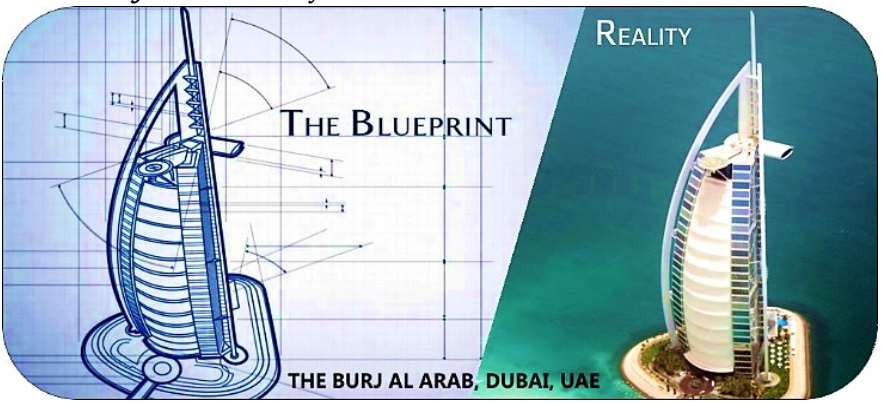
> *"Everything is created twice—first in the mind, then in reality."*

For a house, the first creation is called a ***blueprint***. For a fulfilling day, it's called a ***to-do*** (or to-be) ***list***. For a fulfilled life, a ***vision/dream***. For academic excellence, it's called ***your graduating CGPA.***

Note the 99/1: *the second creation cannot happen without the first.

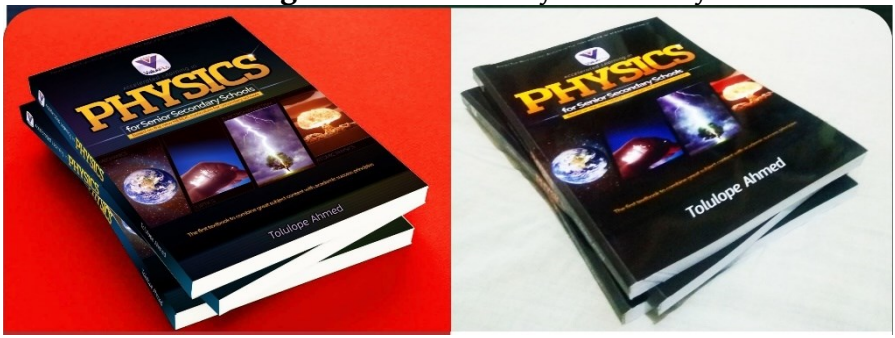
"Imagination is more important than knowledge" — Albert Einstein *"Thought is more important than action."* Because thought causes action. *"Your vision is more important than reality."* Because vision causes reality.

*For the **Burj Al Arab,** the first creation was the BLUEPRINT.*



*The **Pivot Game** was first an idea before it was created and released.*

*The **Accelerated Learning Textbook Series** was first an idea before it was created*



For everyone, the first creation is the ***mental picture*** which must happen before the physical (or second) manifestation (see picture).

Even God said, *"I'm God, I declare the end from the beginning…and I say in advance what has not yet occurred"*[2].

1. **The Second** (or physical) **Creation CANNOT happen without the First**
   Many people are struggling to experience the physical manifestation without ensuring the first creation is fully done. How sad! The first creation is 99% while the physical manifestation is 1% [according to THE TRAINING BALANCE SCALE]. We can say it this way:

   > *"If your first creation is strong enough, your physical manifestation will show up!"*

2. **The Two Creations Are BOTH IMPORTANT For Getting Results**
   Once your goal is clear (e.g. your graduating CGPA), work on it daily.

   > *You can think and plan all you want, but the only people who get results are those who take action—today, tomorrow and every day!*

   > *SUMMARY: "If your academic goal is strong enough (99%), **the necessary actions/applications will naturally suggest themselves to you!** (1%)" And when that happens, take action!*

Your Goal = "A Mental Picture of YOUR Preferred Future"

A goal is a mental picture of a preferable future such that you get excited just by thinking about it. And success is the achievement of that mental picture of a preferable future.

> *What you write down is NOT as important as the picture you continue to hold **in** your mind that keeps you so excited!*

So, next time there's a graduation ceremony in your school, take a gown from a friend, snap yourself in it, and give thanks to God for being one of the best-graduating students in your school now!

So, enough said! Get your pen, let's set your goals…

How to Set Your Academic Goal—*Cumulate your CGPA in advance*

For a 5.0 Grade Point Average (GPA) system, there are 3 main steps:

*#1. **Write** down all your past scores/results (the scores you have seen),*
*#2. **Assume** scores/grades for your awaiting results.*
*#3. **Set** goals for the courses you're presently offering (Hint: set all **A**s)*

Imagine if MY CURRENT ACADEMIC STATUS is 4.33/5.00

KEY	
A	5
B	4
C	3
D	2
E	1
F	0

KEY	
4.50—5.00	1st class
3.5—4.49	2nd upper
2.50—3.49	2nd low
1.50—2.49	3rd class
1.00—1.49	Pass
Below 1.00	Withdraw

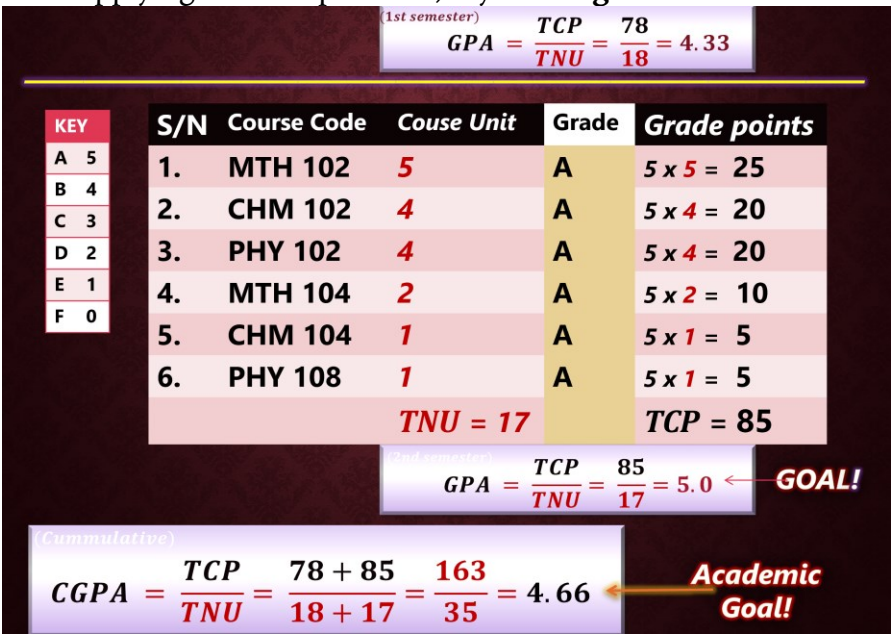
First... How to Calculate your CGPA

S/N	Course Code	Couse Unit	Grade	Grade points
1.	MTH 101	5	C	3 x 5 = 15
2.	CHM 101	4	A	5 x 4 = 20
3.	PHY 101	4	A	5 x 4 = 20
4.	BIO 101	3	A	5 x 3 = 15
5.	CHM 103	1	A	5 x 1 = 5
6.	PHY 107	1	C	3 x 1 = 3
		TNU = 18		TCP = 78

(1st semester)

$$GPA = \frac{TCP}{TNU} = \frac{78}{18} = 4.33 \quad (Second\ Class\ upper)$$

Then applying the 3 steps above, my ***CGPA goal*** will be…



This can be done for all the courses you'll do till you graduate to obtain **your graduating CGPA**. So, get your Students' Handbook, draw the tables, and cumulate your CGPA till graduation.

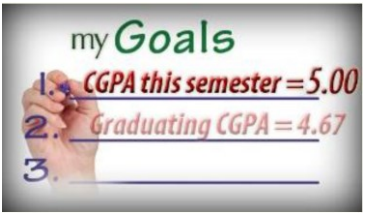
[By the way, the above snapshot (4.33/5.00) was my 100L result at OAU. (first semester) in 2007, but I came back to first class at the end of the second semester, and I kept setting my goals till I eventually graduated as the best!]

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #1– (NEXT FAQ: PAGE 10)

***Q**: Sir, I'm in part 2 (of 5) and my CGPA is currently 2.90/5.00, can I still graduate with a first class (or distinction)?*

***A**: Simple. **Cumulate your CGPA in advance**, and you'll find out whether you can still graduate with first class or not. Get your **Students' Handbook** containing the list of all the courses you'll do in your program, sit down, calculate and obtain **Your Graduating CGPA** yourself!*

Following the Example, Calculate your CGPA in Advance



List all your courses till graduation, set all **A**s then cumulate it all to obtain your graduating CGPA and then place it where you can always see it. Write it here…

MY GRADUATING CGPA: _____

If you filled the above space, you've not only answered the FAQ but also separated yourself from the 95% of students with no goals.

Your RETICULAR ACTIVATING SYSTEM (RAS)

Yet, the main reason you should write out your graduating CGPA now is because of your Reticular Activating System (RAS).

> *Your RAS is the automatic part of your brain that **makes you SEE THE THINGS** that will help you achieve your goal(s).*

For example, if I ask you: *"In the last 7 days, how many red cars have you seen?"* Your answer might probably be *"none," "I can't remember,"* or *"What's my business with red cars?"* etc.

But if I had said to you 7 days ago: *"Let's see how many red cars you will see in the next 7 days",* you will suddenly realize that once you step out into the streets and a red car is passing, you'll immediately notice and count it! Why? Because as you see them, your RAS begins to call them to your attention. The point is this: *your RAS will only function towards achieving the goal you have been preconditioned with.*

Guess what? You may think you did not see any red car with the first example, but guess again? You actually saw several with your eyes but your RAS could not call them to your attention because it was never your goal.

> *So, even though your eyes can see, they still need to be activated to see!*

In order words, the RAS is as though 'dead' when you don't have a clear goal. The bottom line is that *your RAS will start to filter important situations, circumstances, people, books, and things to your consciousness once your goals are truly set!*

> *"We will ONLY be able to recognize opportunities that are right (or in line) with our ALREADY SET GOALS."*

When your goals are set, your Reticular Activating System (RAS) will begin to function *to your advantage*. It's going to look as though opportunities will suddenly begin to suggest (or present) themselves to you. The right books will find you; you'll find them. The right relationships, calls to make, etc. will suggest themselves to you. So, don't allow opportunities to pass you by anymore by setting your goals first!

Doors Open When You Act Boldly with Your End in Mind

Now imagine I'm outside BEHIND THE CROWD. But I have a goal of going straight to the STAGE (located in front). But as you see the whole place is jam-packed with a lot of people such that "there are no visibly available spaces to get to the podium in front," right? However, you'll agree that if I continue walking through the people by simply saying "Please, excuse me", they will give way and I will ultimately get to the podium in front.

A person without such a goal (or a predetermined end in mind) will simply join the crowd and remain there. THE POINT IS: things and people will seem to support you if you act boldly with a sense of your end in mind! Your goal is like a positive force that pulls you from your future towards it! The LAW OF AVERAGE says…

> *"If you do not work towards a predetermined end in life, you will end up in the crowd!"*

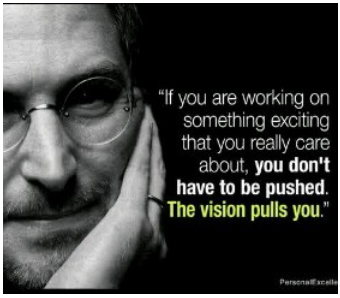
That's why **C** is the widest range students fall in when results are out.

3 Ways to Know You're Moving Towards Your Goals

#1. When you find yourself among the top people in your class

> *"If you find yourself in the company of the top/ excellent people in your class, it's because your goal for academic excellence is set. If you don't, your goal is probably not yet set."*

#2. When you notice you like your work more



A lazy student is one who doesn't have a clear goal to be the best. *Your goal is like a positive force that draws you towards it from the future.* When your goal is set, you will start speaking up more in class, doing assignments, maximizing time, etc.

#3. When you attract the necessary books and the right situations

> *You have attracted this book into your life because you have a genuine desire/goal for academic excellence.*

Your RAS has told you this book is important to you. Remember, "we will only be able to recognize the opportunities that are right (or in line with) our already SET GOALS."

Interestingly, the remainder of this book is about helping you to move from where you are now to where you want to be i.e. your desired academic result.

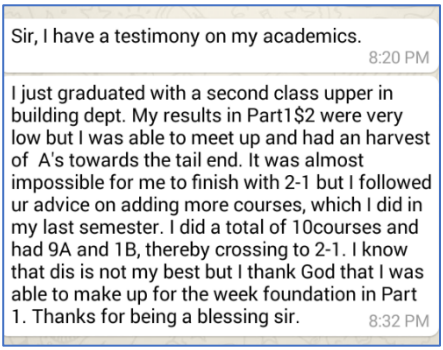
FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #2– (NEXT FAQ: PAGE 27)

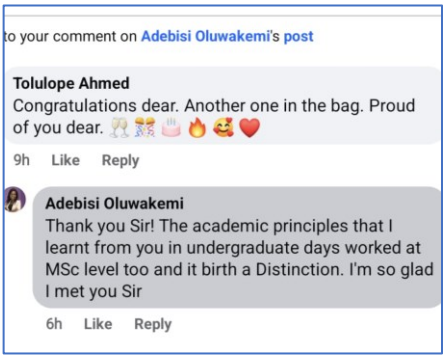
***Q**: Sir, I calculated my graduating CGPA and got 4.49/5.00 (i.e. the tail-end of first-class), how can I still increase or **BOOST** my CGPA further so that I can still graduate with a first class?*

***A**: To Increase your CGPA, YOU NEED TO TAKE EXTRA COURSES THAT YOU'RE SURE YOU WILL GET **A**s in. They are called Free or*

> *Restricted electives. Check your handbook for the simple electives that guarantee **A**s and register for them.*

Here's Oluwakemi's testimony. She *boosted* her graduating CGPA into the ***second-class upper*** division with extra courses (or electives). And went on to obtain a ***distinction*** in her master's programme.





In Summary (Action Step)

You can only experience a future you can see; so, obtain your graduating CGPA and put it where you can always see it. Napoleon Hill puts it better...

> *"There is one quality you must have in order to win. And that is, **definiteness of purpose**— the knowledge of what you want and a burning desire to achieve it." (Napoleon Hill)*

3 Quick Questions

1. Do you recall "**The Law of Average**?"
2. What exactly is the **Reticular Activating System**?
3. How can you Increase/**Boost your CGPA** every semester beyond the norm?

LAW **#2**

Self-Discovery

"Who you think you are, is the result you'll get at the end!"

"If you think you CANNOT get 100%, then YOU WON'T. But if you believe you WILL get 100%, you WILL! So, BELIEVE!"

REMEMBER, IF YOU'RE NOT EXCITED ABOUT YOUR GOAL, YOU don't have a goal set yet. If you *doubt*, it'll block your goal from being achieved. So, permit yourself to be excellent. This chapter will help you…

- discover that *you're already excellent,*
- think BIG, and
- develop your confidence

1. YOU'RE ALREADY EXCELLENT—*You become what you believe*

> *"You do not necessarily believe what you see; instead, **you see what you believe**."*

Jesus puts it this way, *"according to your belief, it shall be done to you."*[1] and *"blessed is he who believes even when he has not yet seen."*[2] If you

think and believe you are an average student, you are! And if you think and believe you are an excellent student, you are—it is your belief that makes it so.

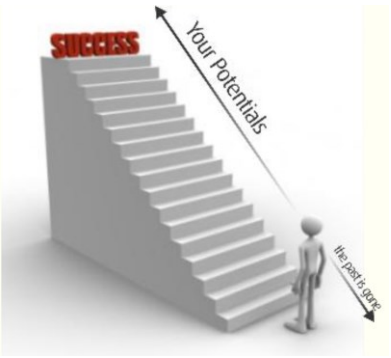
The Law of LIMITS...

> *...states that: "The **only** limit you have in life or academics is the limit you place upon yourself."*

If you have not had plenty **A**s before, (or you've not been in the first position in your class before), don't think *"I am an average student"*—otherwise, you have just placed a limit upon yourself! And that's what you will be—average.

> *Never judge yourself by your past or even the present. Always measure yourself by **the potential of your future**.*

The Potentials of Your Future



Remember in LAW 1 that "the gap between your future goals and where you are now is what is called your '*potentials*'." The way to release your potential is to always define yourself based on the possibilities of your future. On the other hand, the way to limit yourself is to always see yourself based on your past experiences or present circumstances.

Set Your Goals Again!

So, if you've not set 100% A for each of your courses when setting your academic goal in LAW 1, set it again, based on the principle in

this chapter. Do not limit yourself. Free your- self! Believe it is possible! Aim for 100%!

"Were You an Excellent Student from Kindergarten?"

Students ask me this question in many academic seminars, and my answer is the same:

> *"**No**! To begin with, I didn't go to a very good primary/high school. I never had an **A** in my O' Level result; In fact, I never had any **B**. I had all **C**s." But by learning and applying. These same principles, and believing in God's ability in me, I achieved the excellent results I have today!*

And, my goals will amaze you if you see them! If you meet me online, I'll share them with you if you share yours with me.

The problem is that many think to themselves: *"I'm not very brilliant"* or *"I'm too young to…"* or worse, some students even say things like: *"See, I know myself!"*—which places even more limits on them. Don't limit yourself.

Focus on God's ability in you for your future results!

"To think according to appearances is easy, but to think truth regardless of appearances requires the use of more power!"

> *"To get good grades in class, you must forget about how your past results are (good or bad), and focus your attention more on how better you prefer them to be in the next results."*

You become what you think about most

Some time ago, I saw a video titled 'THE SECRET'. The summary of the video is: "All over the world, there's one strange secret of success…

> *"You become what you think about most of the time" Or "you attract to your life what you think about most of the time."*

Well, I wonder why it's called a "secret" when it is so openly put in the Scriptures. First of all, THE LAW OF ATTRACTION states that: *"As a man thinks in his heart, so is he."* Prov. 23:7. Or, *"As water reflects the face of a man, so a man's life is reflected by his heart."* Prov. 27:19. This means,

> *"Life is a mirror. Whatever is found in your heart is what is reflected in your experiences."*

THE SECRET: "Thoughts Become Things."

How it Works

> *"When you think a thought, **your brain emits vibrations** (or frequency or energy). And these vibrations (i.e. your thoughts) are **received by other brains**—other people pick up the thoughts—thereby attracting into your life, situations and events corresponding to that particular thought (whether positive or negative)." – Albert Einstein*

2. THINK BIG–*do you wish to break records?*

Do you have a dream of becoming the best student in the history of your school? Do you have a dream of having 100% in all your courses? It starts with bringing yourself to believe it is possible—for you.

Thinking means "Originating Thoughts"

There's a kind of thinking called "remembering/worrying" (the past). There's another one called "observing/considering" (present). But what we're talking about here is "imagining" or originating thoughts or thinking (future); e.g. solving a math question, having a goal, planning for the future, etc. Remember…

> *"To think according to appearance is easy. But to think **truth, regardless of appearance,** is painstaking and requires the use of more power."*

Thinking regardless of appearance is what is true thinking. It's what creates your experiences/ results. That's the magic. So, free yourself! Dream! Remember the great quote from Marianne Williamson.

> *"Our deepest fear is not that we are inadequate. Our deepest fear is that we are powerful beyond measure. It is actually our own light (not our darkness) that most frightens us.*
>
> *We ask within ourselves, 'Who am I, to be brilliant, excellent, gorgeous, talented, and fabulous?' Actually, **who are you not to be?** You're a child of God. **Your playing/ thinking small does not serve the world.** There's nothing enlightened about shrinking so that other people won't feel insecure around you.*
>
> *We are all meant to shine as children of God. Born to manifest the glory of God that is already within us...and as we are liberated from our own fear, our presence automatically liberates others."*

Think about that statement again: *"…it is even our own light (not our darkness) that most frightens us. We ask ourselves, 'Who am I to be excellent…?' Actually, who are you not to be? You are a child of God…"* You see, we generally tend to underestimate ourselves and overestimate others. Don't!

The Scripture That Changed my Life *(and academics)*

> *"And to the saints that are on the earth, you are the excellent in whom I'm well pleased!"*
>
> **(GOD, PSALM 16:3)**

So, God declared me as the excellent. It means, for the child of God, *"Excellence is not something I should try to live up to. It is simply something I should ensure I do not live below!"* So, I simply ensure I do excellent things!

I like the way my financial mentor, a top-class graduate of Obafemi Awolowo University, Adeolu Akinyemi puts it. He said: *"The day I began to get academically excellent results was not the day I fell and hit my head in the correct place; it was the day I discovered that I am SUPPOSED TO BE THE BEST."*

Because of this scripture, we can boldly say:

> *"You are not a failure trying to succeed. You are already a success who simply needs to take conscious steps to work out the success that is already in you!"*

2. HOW TO DEVELOP CONFIDENCE—*always take action!*

To become confident, always DO what you're afraid of doing! Are you afraid to speak up in class? Then speak up! Afraid to ask questions in class? Then ask questions! Afraid to ask for help from someone? Then ask for help!

Perhaps the greatest success proverb is *"Ask, and it shall be given. Seek, and you shall find. Knock and it shall be opened unto you! Because everyone who asks receives…"* (Jesus Christ, Matthew 7:7)

Action cures fear. If you "always DO what you are afraid to do", then you begin to build and acquire your confidence!

But the longer you think about your fears and the more you don't do something you're afraid to do; the more difficult, and the more impossible it seems. ***Every time you don't speak up because you're afraid***

of speaking up, it is as though you have just taken another dose of confidence poison—your confidence is reduced and your fear increases more. "Action cures fear!" Do this: Right now, think of something you're afraid to do. Then do it!

5-Step Method to Acquiring Your Self-Confidence

1. **Be a Front Sitter**—in class, church, or any gathering. When next you enter a room full of people, go straight to the front.
2. **Practice Making Eye Contact**—The reason some people will not make eye contact is because they lack confidence.
3. **Practice Speaking up in Class**—Listen, even when you're afraid, speak up! You are simply building your confidence.
4. **Walk 25% Faster**—It's been proven that "you can actually change your attitude by changing your posture and speed of movement". The next time you go out, walk faster!
5. **Practice Smiling Big**

Recall…

> *The key to getting to excellence is to continue **practising again and again as though without ending**, until the magic happens.*

The #1 Way to Become Confident–*public speaking*

The most confident people on earth are speakers, ministers, or comedians. If you're afraid to speak in front of an audience, do it anyway! Do it until it becomes normal.

How to Overcome Shyness–*practice speaking out!*

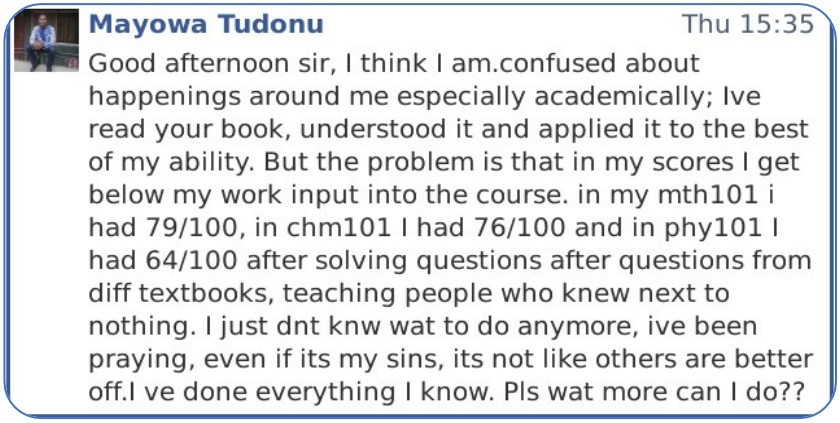
> *"**Just do it!** The first time will not be very convenient, do it anyway! The second time may not leave you*

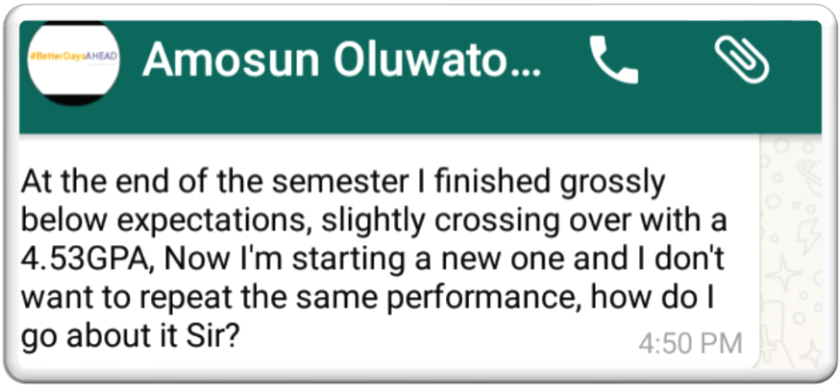
> *with a good experience, but **do it still**. The third time, just do it! Keep doing it again and again...until it becomes normal and the shyness is gone!"*

Every single person you see today who looks bold has gone through the same process! You should do it too!

How to Stop Being an Average Student–*aim to score 100%*

The way to stop being an average student is to always aim to score 100% in any exam you take! Here are some of my students who already understand this and are NOT satisfied with scoring 60s, 70s or 80s. They just want to score 100%. They understand the spirit of this chapter, this book and that of the author. Listen to them…





So, believe too, and aim to score 100% in all your courses.

Give Yourself a Challenging Grading System

Give yourself a new challenging grading system. And aim for 100%.

GENERAL GRADING SYSTEM	*YOUR PERSONAL GRADING SYSTEM*
70% -- 100% = A (5pts)	***80% -- 100% = A (5pts)***
60% -- 69% = B (4pts)	***70% -- 80% = B (4pts)***
50% -- 59% = C (3pts)	***60% -- 69% = C (3pts)***
45% -- 49% = D (2pts)	***55% -- 59% = D (2pts)***
40% -- 44% = E (1pt)	***50% -- 54% = E (1pt)***
0% -- 39% = F (0)	***Below 50 = F (0)***

After a while of thinking this way, your mind will be pushed to desire nothing but excellence. You can't compare yourself with others once you start thinking this way.

In Summary...

Always aim to score 100% in all your courses!

> *"Whatever your mind can conceive, and **believe**, it can achieve!" (Napoleon Hill)*

3 Quick Questions

4. Do you remember the LAW OF LIMITS?
5. How do you overcome shyness, and become bold/confident?
6. How do you stop being an average student and be excellent?

LAW **#3**

Positive Learning Attitude

"Your lecturers are part of your academic excellence!"

*"If your lecturers notice that you want to get **A**s in their courses, they will help you get **A**s in their courses!"*

THIS IS THE ONLY CHAPTER THAT TALKS ABOUT THE LECTURERS' side of academics. You won't find many books or seminars that show you how to *leverage your lecturers* for excellent grades. This chapter teaches you two things…

1. *Learn on your own every single day!*
2. *Ensure your lecturers hold a positive impression of you about the courses.*

1. LEARN EVERY DAY! —*and your learning attitude becomes more positive.*

Every success formula emphasizes continuous learning…

$$S = (d + g + a)i^2$$

Success = (**d**esire + **g**oal + **a**ction) **i**nformation^2

i.e. you need to double the rate of your learning.

If you desire excellence in any subject of life, you need to have READ BOOKS in that subject, EQUAL TO THE NUMBER OF YOUR AGE. Remember, THE TEACHABILITY INDEX— *"The less you learn, the more you think you know. But the more you learn, the more you realize that there is even more to learn!"* It's been said that "The right knowledge reduces risk!" Yes, it also reduces fear—usually the fear of the unknown. Too bad, ignorance doesn't hurt!

4 Quick Ways to Develop Yourself–*how to increase your IQ*

1. **Ask Questions**—every time you hear or see a strange thing or word you don't understand, ask "What is the meaning?"

> *"Asking questions shows that you spend good time thinking!"*

2. **Read Books**—Reading books will make you older than your age and ahead of your mates. Your Intelligence Quotient increases $\left(IQ = \frac{your\ knowledge\ age}{your\ real\ age}\right)$. I charge you, READ BOOKS! Especially the ones recommended by mentors for your goals.

> *"A book is a **door**—a doorway into a new world, a new mindset and an expansion of your imagination and consciousness."*

3. **Observe**—this makes you learn things that need not be said. A person who observes will ask meaningful questions. It makes you discerning, perceptive and wise.

4. **Walk with Brilliant People**—this is the most important. If you consciously do this, you will be doing the above three points simultaneously. Close up with first class senior colleagues.

   Become friends with the best in class and the most brilliant lecturer in your department. And learn from them always!

Best Definitions for Education

> *"Education means training a person's mind till the point that he can solve a problem and get paid for it!" – Tolulope Ahmed*

I define it this way so you can see the benefit of learning, and consequently develop a love for it. Education is about inspiring one's mind, not just filling their head.

> *"A person is educated if he knows how to get what he wants without violating the rights of others." – Napoleon Hill*

Benjamin Franklin, Micheal Faraday & Apostle Paul

Benjamin Franklin had only 3 years of formal education. He became educated through personal development. Michael Faraday had no formal education, but by a most formidable program of reading, he became the most acclaimed scientist of his time at age 44.

Also consider Paul, The Apostle. He was also a die-hard learner. He said to Timothy, "The cloak I left at Troas with Carpus, when you come, bring with you, and the BOOKS, but especially my **parchments** [my NOTES]"[1] In fact, it was said of him: "…Paul, you are insane. **too much learning is making you mad!**'"[2]

The people above are believers. The first two [Benjamin Franklin and Michael Faraday] were stack illiterates but they became world renowned because they were believers with positive learning attitudes—people with an unreserved commitment to learning!

> *We must not confuse spirituality with laziness.*

2. TELL YOUR LECTURERS YOU WANT TO SCORE A's

> *"If your lecturers notice that you want to score **A**s in their courses, THEY WILL ENGAGE IN BEHAVIOURS THAT WILL HELP YOU score **A**s in their courses!*

If your lecturers like you, they'll engage in behaviours (subconsciously) to pass you. And if they don't, they'll engage in behaviours to *show* you. Let me say it again very unequivocally…

> *"YOUR LECTURERS ARE PART OF YOUR ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE!" They will support you if you prove to them that you desire **A**s in their courses.*

"Lecturer's Perception Affects Students' Results"—*Research*

In 1966, Harvard professors Robert Rosenthal and Lenore Jacobson conducted an experiment: Teachers were told that certain kids in their classes were geniuses even though they were not. At the end of the day, those kids received exceptionally high grades. The research's conclusion is this:

> *"It was the lecturer's perception of the child's intelligence that had the greatest influence on the child's learning."*

Call it a bias, prejudice or whatever. It works, period! However, it also works the other way—if the lecturer perceives (or thinks) that the students in his class aren't geniuses, they're likely to receive average (or low) grades from him; and it will also negatively affect the students' learning! Don't let this happen to you. Ensure a positive perception in your lecturers' minds!

How to Apply This to Your Academics

The following are the ways to leverage your lecturers for your academic excellence. It's about ensuring that your lecturers have a positive impression about you. The rest would take care of itself.

1. **ENGAGE YOUR LECTURERS: ask and answer questions in class** — Go to class early, be a front-sitter, contribute in class, have good/standard notes, dress well, be a model; Greet/engage your lecturers, go to their offices to ask them questions/counsels for life after school, or just by asking *"what do I need to pay attention to for me to get an A in your course?"* Pay attention to the response and follow up where necessary. Enjoy learning! Do it consciously. It's your life!

2. **ENSURE YOUR LECTURERS HOLD A POSITIVE IMPRESSION OF YOU**!

> *When your lecturers see that you have a positive learning attitude, they'll help you and vice-versa.*

The 4 kinds of impressions you can hold in your lecturers' minds are:

- **Good** impression *(lecturers think you're good and deserve good results).*
- **Bad** impression *(lecturers think you're not serious and deserve a bad grade).*
- **Mixed** impression, *(lecturers aren't sure whether you're good or bad).*
- **No** impression *(in their minds, you're nothing but a matric number).*

The worst kind of impression is to hold "No impression." But if you develop a positive learning attitude, and then become actively engaged with your lecturers, you will eventually hold a POSITIVE impression in your lecturers' minds.

3. **AS CLASS REP, IF THE LECTURER LIKES YOU, HE'LL LIKE THE CLASS** — By definition, you are 'the class' to your lecturers. Research says…

> *"Classes with good Class Reps generally have good results while classes with irresponsible Class Reps generally have average or bad results."*

In Summary...

If you ensure you *hold a positive impression* in your lecturer's hearts, they will engage in behaviours that will help you get **A**s in their courses.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #3– *(NEXT FAQ: PAGE 45)*

***Q**: Sir, you said to always answer past questions, but my department doesn't release past questions (or it's CBT) or they set questions differently from PQs, what do I do? Or how do I get the right questions?*

***A**: Ask your lecturers to give you more practice questions and assignments. (the questions they give you are an indication of what is coming). If you have a positive impression in their minds, they'll give you.*

3 Quick Questions

1. Do you remember the true meaning of EDUCATION?
2. Do you remember the 4 quick ways to develop yourself?
3. How do you leverage your lecturer to achieve excellent grades?

LAW **#4**

Discipline

"What you do NOW, is cumulatively what you get at the end.!"

*"You make daily progress by making yourself DO **what you know is right to do NOW**, whether you feel like it or not"*

DISCIPLINE IS THE ABILITY TO MAKE YOURSELF DO WHAT YOU know is right to do — whether you feel like it or not. Discipline means *doing what is important, right now!* i.e. no procrastination.

Action vs. Feelings

"You are more likely to act yourself into good feelings than feel yourself into good action" (Jerome Bruner). So, act! Don't wait for a feeling.

> *If you don't feel like reading because your body needs energy, then you need to take care of your body first. But if the feeling is from "laziness", then you need to be disciplined—get started and then the feeling/motivation will come.*

"Starting" Requires Strength but "Continuing" is Easy!

In Science, this idea is called *"Overcoming **inertia**."* i.e.

> *You will always need more energy at the beginning of doing something, but afterwards, it will become easy.*

For example, the energy it takes to start running is more than the energy it takes to keep running. more than the energy it takes to keep running. The energy required to start answering past questions is more than the energy required to keep solving the questions. In other words, once you start answering the questions, it becomes easier to keep answering more questions.

Making your first million is the hardest. But guess what? Once you put all your energies into making your first million, it becomes easy to make several other millions.

"Starting" requires strength, but "continuing" is easy. So, just start! That's discipline. Try it and see! Then practice it until you become competent. Share this with your friends today!

3-Step Method to Becoming Disciplined

1. **Just Get Started!**

   > *You see, going from "doing nothing" to "doing something" is sometimes the hardest part. And it usually takes about 10 minutes after getting started to become engaged. But guess what? Once you've reached this level of engagement, you may even find it hard to stop!*

   So, all you need to do is sit down, block out any distractions (all electronics, etc.), and just dive in!

2. **Practice doing important things "Once and For All"**

   I learnt the phrase, *"…once and for all",* from my Mum. She is a very hardworking woman. So anytime she wants something done, she

would always say, "Tolulope, make sure you do ____ *once and for all."*

3. **Don't Stop Until You're 100% done!**
   Say, *"I don't stop when I'm tired, I stop when I'm done!"* Don't jump from one task to another without ensuring that the first one is 100% complete. Single-handling is also a good way to do things "once and for all!"

The Key is, "Get Started!"

"The Secret to getting ahead in life is '**GETTING STARTED**!' Once the goal is clear, start first, then Improve as you go! No one has control of tomorrow. The only thing you have control over is THE PRESENT MOMENT."

The Law of DIMINISHING INTENT

> *"The longer you wait to do something you KNOW you should do NOW, the greater the chances that you will never eventually do it."*

"He who observes the wind will not sow. He who considers the wind will not reap." (Eccl. 11:4). So, act NOW! You see, the only influence you will ever have over your life (past & future) is what you do NOW! Yesterday is gone and tomorrow is always out of reach.

Discipline Therefore means...

"Getting started immediately on doing the important things for your academics once and for all" or *"Getting started in doing your work until they are 100% complete"*.

2 Instant Benefits of Being Disciplined

- ✓ **It Eliminates Procrastination**: Once you realize you don't have tomorrow, then you stop postponing actions. Even Jesus said…

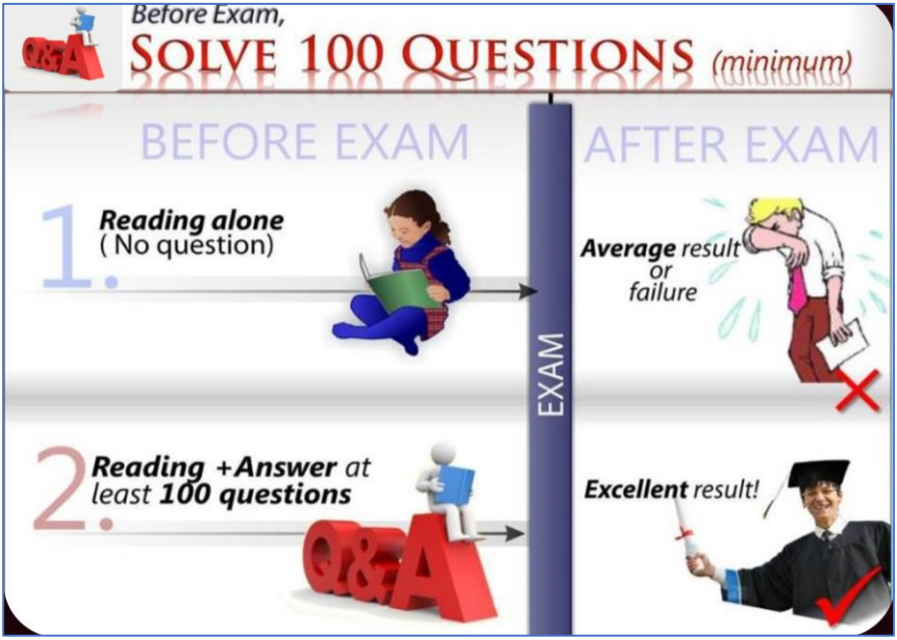
> *"Don't take today's assignment into tomorrow… Today's trouble is ENOUGH FOR TODAY"*[3].

- ✓ **Gets You Ready for Opportunities:** Opportunities come, but you will miss them if you are not prepared. Discipline prepares you for tomorrow's opportunities. For example, you'll crush an impromptu quiz or test tomorrow because you've been answering PQs daily. Or you might be the best to be selected for a Competition in future if you answer questions daily.

Therefore, prepare for tests/exams in advance

QUESTION: When is the best period to prepare for exams? You're probably thinking, "Exam period," Right? Wrong!

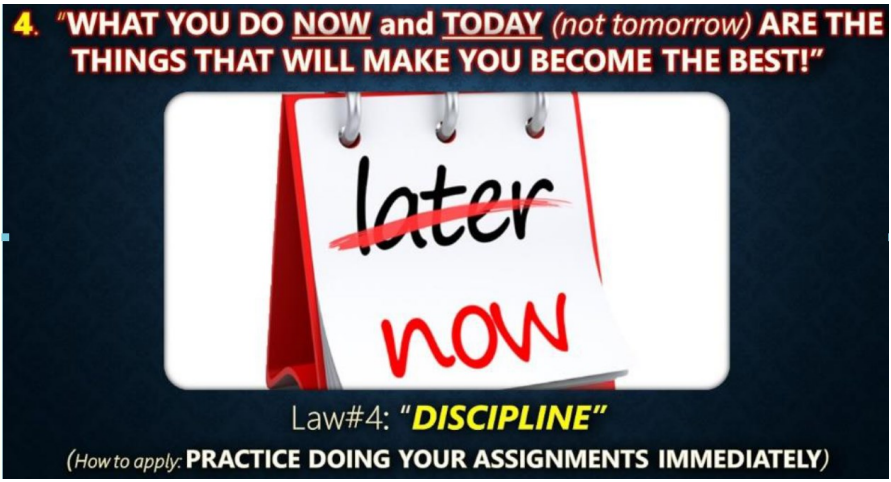
> *The beginning of the semester is the best time to prepare for exams. Start Q&As as early as possible!*



If you always discipline yourself to start documenting answers to PQs early in the semester you will do well in any impromptu tests.

In Summary...

> *If you can do it now, **DO IT NOW**!*



3 Quick Questions

1. What exactly is DISCIPLINE?
2. Do you remember the Law of DIMINISHING INTENT?
3. Have you experienced the two instant benefits of discipline before?

LAW **#5**

Time Management

"Spend time doing ONLY things that'll help you achieve your CGPA goal."

"The 24 hours in a day is an empty space. Whatever you do in the day, is what it will be to you at the end of the day!"

TIME MANAGEMENT SKILL IS THE ABILITY TO SPEND MORE OF your time DOING THE THINGS THAT WILL give you the BEST result at the end of the semester.

Time management is about the *conversion of time into value*. For example, what have you converted the last 5 hours into? What has it generated in terms of results (money, knowledge, completed jobs, or in your case *more documented solutions to past questions*)? Time management is not about doing plenty of things in less time. It is about *"choosing to do only the things that will give you the best results."*

What if Money Was Time?

I saw a wonderful movie some time ago that really showed how valuable time truly is. The title of the movie was "IN TIME" (I

recommend you see the movie as well). In this movie, the currency you spend is time. Each person had his/her own time on his/her wrist which was always *counting down*. If you want to buy anything in the market, you buy it with your time (an amount of time is deducted from your entire life). Also, when you want to earn a

salary, an amount of time will be added to your entire life (instead of cash). And when your time reads "zero", you simply fall and die. The movie equated time to life (and money). Think about it very well, and you'll realize it's true! Your life = time (and money)!

Think about it. We spend time every time, for everything we do! The quantity of time you have is all you need to *convert* into the first-class (or any other achievement) you desire. This chapter shows you how to do that.

The 80/20 Principle—states that…

> *'About 80% of your academic efforts will produce 20% of your results. And 20% of those efforts will produce 80% of your results.'*

So, you only need to focus on the **key 20% of academic activities** that will give you 80% of your desired results. That's how to manage time academically—by doing ONLY the important things that bring the best results. LAW #7 and LAW #8 are perfect applications of the 80/20 principle and I summarized it into this statement that's the response to the question: *What's the most important factor for academic excellence?*

> *"'Document answers to past/likely questions throughout the semester for you to practice/review them for your exams.' This habit is perhaps the central pillar of this book."*

So, what key 20% activities give the best RESULTS?

These should make your ideal day. Count your day/week as *fulfilling* if any of these activities are well done that day/week.

1. Document new answers to PQs in your Solutions note (LAW #7)
2. Engaging your lecturers positively (LAW #3)
3. Doing at least one ***self-test*** per week (LAW #8)

These key activities move you closer to having all **A**s per semester. I tell my students…

> *"Once your self-tests are beginning to yield high scores, then you know that you're likely to answer all the questions in the exam and score 100%."*

So, Time Management is simply about *"doing only the things that lead to your goals."* If there's no set goal, there's nothing to manage the time towards.

3-Step Method to Managing Time

1. GET ORGANIZED (getting started)
2. Use the "CUSHION PRINCIPLE" (how to meet deadlines)
3. Use a TO-DO LIST (the principal way to manage time)

#1. GET ORGANIZED!

a. **Get a Reading Place at home**—Here, you have your academic goal pasted where you can always see it, document new answers to PQs and do your weekly self-tests.

b. **Get a permanent Reading Place in the library**—A permanent study place allows your mind to be calm and collected for more productive thinking as you continue to study there with time. Use the library; because classrooms, computer rooms, etc., by definition, are not designed for studying.

#2. USE THE CUSHION PRINCIPLE–*to meet deadlines!*

I formulated this principle to solve the African time problem. It says...

> *"If you want to **achieve a target in the future**, aim to complete that task in a time **before** the publicly stated deadline."*

For example, if I have an exam **two months** from now, I'll prepare for it as though it is **next month**. If we're to submit an assignment by **Friday**, I

will work to submit it by **Wednesday**. If I want to get to class by **7:00 a.m.**, I will work to get there by **6:45 a.m**. The 15-minute gap is the cushion. It saves me from being late. Some people set their clocks 15 minutes faster than normal to implement this principle.

Applying the Cushion Principle

1. Study ahead of the class. Prepare as though the exam is tomorrow.
2. Tell your lecturers to give you practice questions every week.
3. Try to always do your assignments immediately with friends (not at home).
4. If you want to spend N5000 in the market, you must (secretly) aim to spend about N4000 before you set out in the first place.
5. If you are to submit an assignment (or complete a task) by Thursday, you must (secretly) aim to finish by Tuesday!
6. If you want to get **A**s, you must (secretly) aim to score 100%.
7. If you have 5 goals for the new year, aim to achieve them all by June.

More Applications of the Cushion Principle

Leaders, this is key to maintaining ***brevity*** when planning meetings.

1. If you want to have a program that would last for 2 hours, your written programme should be to genuinely finish in 1 hour, 45 minutes or less.
2. If you have a goal to make 1 million, aim for 10 million secretly.
3. If you are invited to speak at a program for 50 minutes, plan to genuinely finish your speech under 40 minutes. It has been said that maintaining brevity in public speaking or meetings is not easy; but with the Cushion Principle, brevity can become a habit.

In our first year, we wanted to sell 100,000 copies of this book, but we ended up selling about 8,400 copies. If we had aimed for 8400 copies would have sold next to nothing. Now, we target *1 million.*

As I earlier said, some people instead readjust their wristwatches to be 10 or 15 minutes faster and they stick to it as the normal time. This is OK, but I recommend you to learn how to use the CUSHION PRINCIPLE better than this; because the CUSHION PRINCIPLE is not just about the few minutes. It applies to hours, days, weeks, months, years and decades ahead. Imagine having a well-written 50-year plan. You'll develop an amazing sense of urgency and leadership; I'd tell you that.

#3. USE A "TO-DO" LIST

A to-do (or to-be) list is a list of the KEY things to get done in a day. For example, the key 20% activities that give the best results (page 35). They are the things to fill your day with. I use the Mobisle Note app and Google Keep for this.

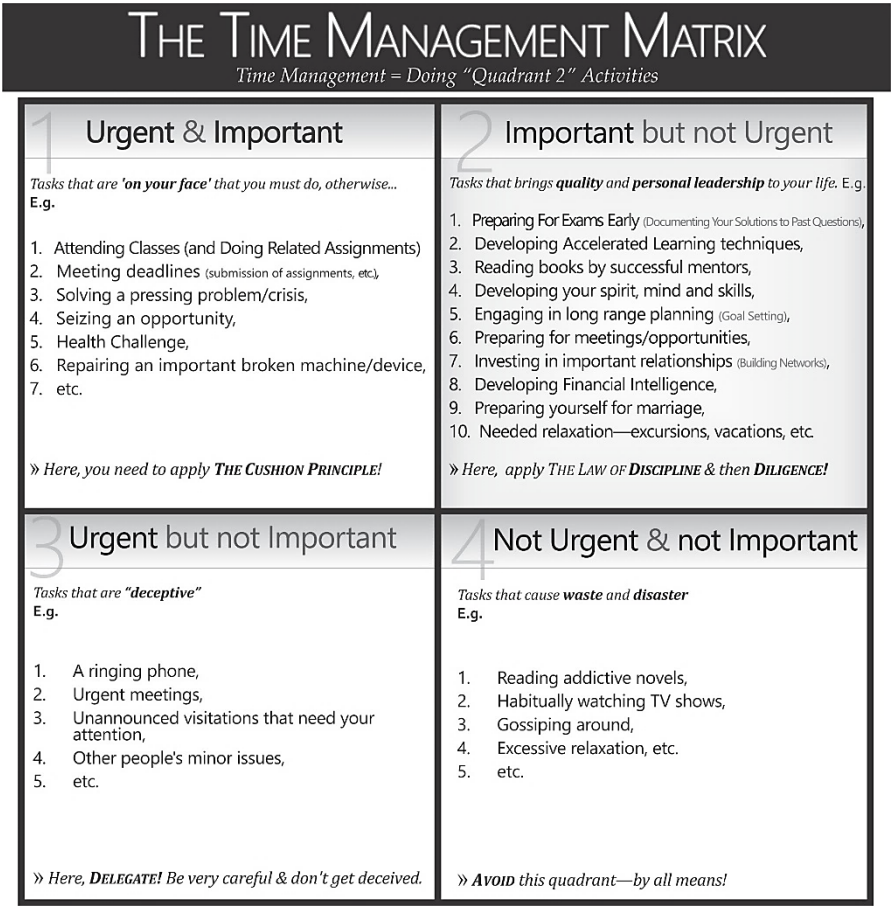
> *Using a to-do list will increase your effectiveness by **25%** the first day you start using it (if you are not using one already).*

So, how do you know what should or should not be on your list? Short answer: Include only QUADRANT 2 activities of the Time Management Matrix.

The Time Management Matrix—*by Stephen R. Covey, Author.*

There are four categories of things we all do:

1. **URGENT & IMPORTANT**: These are things on your face. You can't put them off. See QUADRANT 1 in the matrix.
2. **IMPORTANT** [but not Urgent]: (e.g. personal development, learning or upgrading your skills, physical fitness and exercise, applying health principles, they are the things that bring noticeable positive change to your life. They are the emphasis of this book. See QUADRANT 2 of the matrix.



3. **URGENT** [but not Important]: See QUADRANT #3. You don't have to attend all church programs. Simply inform your leader when you can't make it.
4. **NOT IMPORTANT & NOT URGENT:** See QUADRANT #4 in the matrix.

Your To-do List should only include QUADRANT 2 activities

Your to-do list may just be 3 of these *key* activities:

1. *document at least 15 new solutions to past questions.*
2. *Call and meet with a senior colleague to collect PQs, notes & Materials*
3. *Engage lecturers positively.*

You don't need to include QUADRANT 1 activities; they will get you whether you list them or not.

Weekly Planning is more important than Daily Planning

Organizing weekly provides much greater balance and context than daily planning. Daily planning limits vision. It blocks you from seeing things that can only be seen when you think long-term. The very language of "daily planning" focuses on the "urgent" (the "now") rather than the "important". Therefore, your daily to-do list must always aim at achieving some objectives in the week… and ultimately towards your academic goal.

> ***Example**: If I have a test in **two weeks**, the cushion principle teaches me to prepare for the test as though it is **next week**. Therefore, my "daily" to-do list this week, is:*
>
> *1. Documenting answers to past questions, 2. Doing at least one Self-test with other top students in the class like me.*

A person who creates a 5-year plan is far greater than the person who has a 5-day plan! Once you plan long-term, you'll suddenly start acting wise. *Wisdom is the natural demonstration of long-term thinking!*

With Leverage, you can use more than 24 hours/day

Yes, you read that correctly! Leverage = *"getting more done with less."*

> *Leverage = "getting more done by using other people's time, money and resources—while they are getting results as well". It means "1% of the effort of 100 people rather than 100% of your effort".*

It simply means "Other People's Everything!" (OPE). You can also leverage things—equipment or technology. It's amazing!

Here are 3 quick ideas on leverage:

1. **Leverage on People**—*Delegate your QUADRANT 3 items to friends*

   To use 1% of the effort of 100 people, you need a lot of leadership skills. Remember, one of the greatest principles of success is *"Ask and it shall be given unto you!"* If you are already thinking: *"But… I don't have friends,"* then start building and nurturing relationships deliberately. If you say "My friends will not answer me", then you are limiting yourself. You are giving yourself an answer even before you know the options. Every excuse you give for not building relationships limits your capacity to generate results.

   Listen, your friends will help you. And the reason they will is because you have a relationship with them. Period! THE LAW OF NETWORKS says, "The bigger your network, the more doors can open for you". Leverage the networks of people around you.

   Genuinely meet and value people, increase your phone/Facebook contacts deliberately, and nurture the important ones. I recommend you read the Dale Carnegie book, "HOW TO WIN FRIENDS AND INFLUENCE PEOPLE," again.

2. **Leverage on Technology**—*Buy devices that do your work faster*
   - **Automatic Rice Cooker** *(which cooks your food without burning, and keeps it warm even when you're not around)*.
   - **Computer and Printer/Copier** *(instead of looking for it around all the time),*
   - **Smart Phone and AI Tools**. *Use this link to sign up for Google Labs to gain access to Help Me Write (Docs/Gmail), Help Me Analyze (Sheets), Help Me Visualize (Slides), etc.* - ***workspace.google.com/labs-sign-up***

3. **Leverage on Money**—*Practice spending money to save time.*

Rather than "wasting time to save money," learn to "spend money to save time" sometimes. Rich people spend money to save time while poor person squanders a lot of time to conserve little money.

Take a bike or cab once in a while instead of walking all the time. If you get more time, you can use it to develop other areas of your life — leadership, communication skills, teaching skills, financial intelligence, etc.

You are probably thinking, *"Well, all these ideas are nice but… what if I don't have the money to do all these?"* Good question. And I have two answers for you:

i. **Don't Give Any Excuse**! "It's okay if you don't have the money available to you now, BUT in your mind, **do not justify it**—don't justify not spending money to save time! Always think of leverage and abundance, not impossibility and scarcity. Remember, you don't believe what you see, you see what you believe.

ii. **Develop Financial Intelligence**! You can learn ideas for generating income streams part-time in CHAPTER 12*: "**7 SIMPLE IDEAS FOR GENERATING INCOME STREAMS AS A STUDENT**" or at my blog: www.to- lulopeahmed.wordpress.com. However, you must bury it in your mind that access to more income gives you more time freedom!

> *"Even the ideas that are permitted to come into your head are dependent on the cash you currently have access to."*

If you don't have access to good income, your RAS will not call your attention to opportunities that good income will make you see (even if the opportunities are right before your naked eyes).

3 Ways to Deal with Distractions

1. **Be Principled:** You must have standing principles that people know you for. For instance, people should be able to RESPECT YOUR TIME. People should not just visit you anytime and anyhow they like, unannounced.

   Let anyone who wants to visit you respect you enough to call you so that you can put the person's visit on your to-do list (or at least be expecting him/her). You would have to give attention [time] to anyone who visits you unannounced and because you did not have the person in your plan earlier, your time would be wasted. Some people say it is a 'surprise visit.'

   Good friends would always think of your plans and availability [as well as the importance of the visit] before they pay you a surprise visit. If not, they just have to call you to find out whether you will be available. That's what good friends do; they call, they ask you if you've got time for this or for that, etc. They respect your time. Say it to yourself every day: "Nobody has the right to take my time anyhow!"

2. **Get back on track by saying, "I need to get back to work.**" While following your plans, if someone interrupts and keeps wasting your time, say to the person *'I need to get back to work'* or *'to be continued!'* Sometimes, you might want to just check a name on your phone and from there; you get carried away in checking pictures and other multimedia. Just say, 'back to work' or 'to be continued'. Don't just think it; SAY IT!
3. **Don't Read Around Music (or around people you know):** Some people claim to read best by playing music alongside. Most people do this because they usually find the study period quite

boring. So, they hope the music will get them a little excited and possibly help the study period to be effective. There is what is called THE LAW OF SUBSTITUTION.

> *THE LAW OF SUBSTITUTION: "The conscious mind can process ONLY ONE information at a time"*

Listen, you cannot read and listen to music at the same time. It can't be effective. If you read, say for 30 minutes while the music is going on, trust me, you have actually spent some 20 minutes for effective study and 10 minutes for effective listening to the music—the conscious mind can process only one stream of information at a time. However, a voiceless, beatless, soft background sound that doesn't require any conscious processing by the mind can be quite effective.

Don't study around TV or social media like TikTok, Instagram, etc. They can lock you into what is called DOOM SCROLLING!

Another Application of the CUSHION PRINCIPLE

Give yourself a new challenging grading system. And always aim for 100%.

GENERAL GRADING SYSTEM	YOUR PERSONAL GRADING SYSTEM
70% -- 100% = A (5pts)	***80% -- 100% = A (5pts)***
60% -- 69% = B (4pts)	***70% -- 80% = B (4pts)***
50% -- 59% = C (3pts)	***60% -- 69% = C (3pts)***
45% -- 49% = D (2pts)	***55% -- 59% = D (2pts)***
40% -- 44% = E (1pt)	***50% -- 54% = E (1pt)***
0% -- 39% = F (0)	***Below 50 = F (0)***

After a while of thinking this way, your mind will be pushed to desire nothing but excellence. You can't compare yourself with others once you start thinking this way.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #4– (NEXT FAQ: PAGE 52)

***Q**: Sir, how do I maintain the balance between my academics and all other activities I'm involved with?*

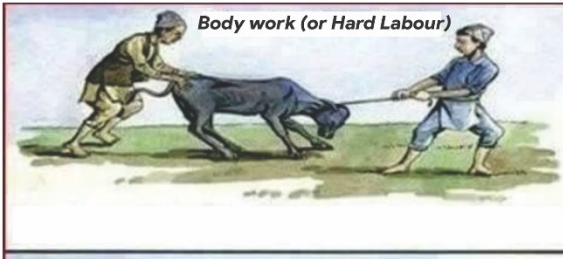
***A**: First cut wastes (any QUADRANT 4 activities or things you should simply say NO to). Things that are not in line with your goals. Second, **Turn the time management principles above into a habit**, especially the 3 ideas about LEVERAGING. Trust me, you need to develop how to save and use more time productively because it will help you A LOT even after graduation.*

In Summary…

> *Spend your time doing only the activities that will lead to your CGPA goal.*

3 Quick Questions

1. Do you remember what the 80/20 PRINCIPLE is?
2. How about the CUSHION PRINCIPLE?
3. What are the top 20% of activities that yield the best academic results?



LAW **#6**

Diligence

"True hard work is when your brain is doing most of the work."

"If you don't train your mind so that you work smart, you will do the work with your body; which is called 'Physical Labour."

DILIGENCE MEANS HARD WORK (OR BRAIN WORK). MOST people confuse hard labour with hard work. The person who is working more with his brain (not his body) is the person who is working hard. What some call smart work *is* hard work. That's why the coach averagely gets paid more than the players, and the manager gets paid more than the field workers. It's because they use their brain more than their physical bodies. Jesus said…

> *"A student is not greater than his teacher. But the student who **WORKS HARD** will become like the teacher." Luke 6:40 NLT*

Diligence is NOT Hard Labour!

Diligence is "99% mental work and 1% physical follow-up". I tell people, *"If you cannot train your mind till the point that it can productively work for you, you will become stuck with your body to do all the work. And this is what we call 'Hard Labour.'"* Hard work is smart or brain work. That's the true meaning of diligence.

Diligence is about practising QUADRANT 2 activities until the brain does it automatically. Did you observe that most QUADRANT 2 activities are not physical activities but mental work? Look at it this way: TIME MANAGEMENT means *"focus on QUADRANT 2 activities"* while DILIGENCE means *"forming habits with QUADRANT 2 activities."*

Diligence in Academics

Remember, to become excellent at something, you need to practise, and practise, and practise, and practise, and practise consciously over and over again… until one day… something magical happens (without your permission)—you just suddenly realize that you're doing it without thinking!" So, to be diligent in academics:

1. ***Whatever you're told to do, DO IT!***
2. Write your Academic Goal (CGPA)—*every new semester,*
3. *Answer **PQ**s DAILY*
4. *Always do tests & your **corrections**,*
5. Always go and ask your best lecturers important questions.

Diligence in Other Areas of Your Life

The major reason why you need to develop excellence in other areas of your life is so that it will continue to have a positive effect on your academics. The list in QUADRANT 2 includes:

1. Start learning financial intelligence. Play the **Cash Flow Game**. Read ***Rich Dad, Poor Dad,*** *etc.*
2. Develop *computer skills. Use **Mavis Beacon** Teaches Typing.*
3. Read books/Listen to audio trainings from trusted authors—*on effective communication*, etc.,
4. Long Range Planning—***life after SCHOOL**, your 5-year goal, etc.,*
5. Anticipating and preventing problems
6. *Read the book: **"How to Win Friends and Influence People"** (by Dale Carnegie)*
7. Go on *vacation* during holidays.

Imagine you've become very good at the activities above; you'll be operating beyond your age. I have heard people (in an idle state) say things like, "I just don't know what to do!" Maybe you've even said it many times. The list above contains activities your mind

should go to any time you feel there is nothing for you to do. It will surprise you to know that you have too much to do already!

He That Does Not Work Should Not Eat!

Paul, full of the Holy Spirit, said categorically,

> *"We give you this **COMMAND** WITH THE AUTHORITY OF OUR LORD JESUS CHRIST: Stay away from any child of God who lives in idleness and doesn't follow the tradition of **HARD WORK** we gave you. For you know you OUGHT to follow our example. WE WERE NEVER LAZY when we were with you...WE WORKED HARD day and night so that we would not be a burden to any of you...[because] we wanted to give you AN EXAMPLE to follow."*[2]

The Apostle Paul was a hard-working person, even though he had a wonderful measure of the anointing. Many people only see the Apostle Paul as a "religious" believer. He was a hard-working believer. Hard work and anointing do not conflict; in fact, they work together. He continued and said,

> *"Yet we hear that some of you are living idle lives, refusing to work and wasting time meddling in other people's business. In the Name of the Lord Jesus Christ, we appeal to such people—NO, WE COMMAND THEM: SETTLE DOWN AND GET TO WORK. Earn your own living!"*[2]

You see, the simple definition of FAITH is "acting according to God's instructions concerning a matter." As a child of God, your faith works by acting on God's instructions. Until you act, God will not perform. Every great man in the scriptures who did excellently was studious and diligent [i.e. hard working]. The Bible says of Solomon: *"he was wiser than anyone else and could speak with authority about all kinds of things."* The same Solomon wrote, "WORK HARD and become a leader; be

lazy and become a slave." "See you a man DILIGENT in his business? He shall stand before kings; he shall not stand before obscure (or mere) men." He was a hard-working king—because if he was not, he would not have written that.

Exams test your preparedness more than your intelligence

It has been discovered that you don't need *plenty of time* for a massive, long-hour reading (or studying), all you need is **just enough** time to study (or answer questions) WITH CONSISTENCY. And your preparedness is how much you've dutifully gone through the requirements of your classes.

How many hours should you study per day?

Students usually ask me this question. My answer is simple: *"The number of hours you spend studying is irrelevant; what is important is **how many questions you can answer during the study period**!"* More about this in the next chapter.

Diligence = 99% Mental Work + 1% Physical Follow-up

Brain experts tell us that our brains don't grow old from "working too hard" but from "hardly working at all."

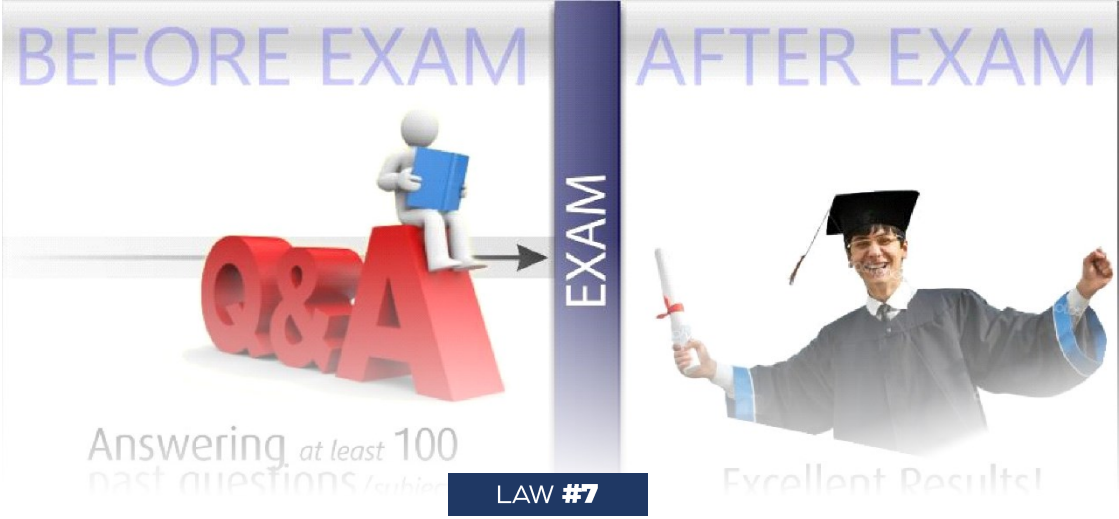
> *"If you don't train your mind so that you work smart, you will do the work with your body; which is called 'Physical Labour'"*

In Summary...

> *Diligence is about the use of the brain. The **consistency** in studying until the brain works for you (instead of your body).*

3 Quick Questions

1. What's the difference between Hard Work and Hard Labour?
2. What's the relationship between Hard work and Smart work?
3. What's your attitude towards mental work? Dodge it or Face it gladly?



LAW **#7**

Past Questions

"The more questions you answer, the more you can answer questions."

"IF ALL YOU DO from today till the day of your exam is to answer past questions every single day, then you're likely to answer all the questions in the exam and score 100%!"

THE PROCESS OF ANSWERING QUESTIONS NOT ONLY MAKES YOU learn fast but also develops your academic intelligence. i.e. the more you answer questions, the more you can answer questions. And that's what people describe as "intelligent student."

> *The more you answer questions, the more you* ***develop the ability*** *(or intelligence) to give answers to more questions.* *(see the diagram on the next page)*

Lecturer's Questions are Indicators for the Exam

"Past Questions give directions as to WHAT and HOW to study, without it, you lack direction". Listen, one of my lecturers at OAU once said to me: "When your lecturers give you some questions, they're trying to hint you on what you should expect in the exam".

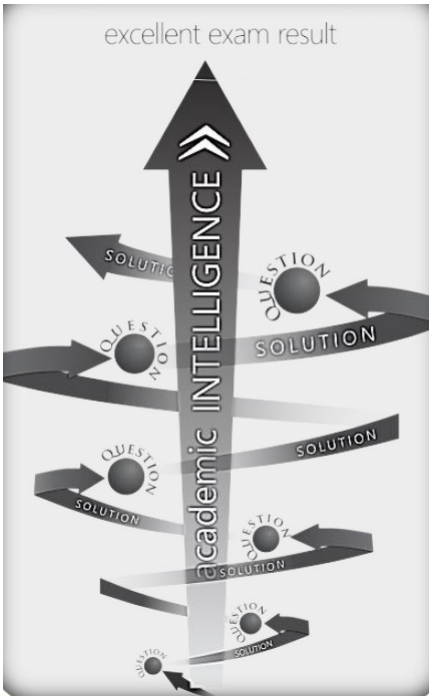
And if your lecturers are not giving you enough questions, ask them to do so— whether the course is Engineering or Law.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #5– (NEXT FAQ: PAGE 59)

***Q**: Sir, why is it that after reading well, I get to the exam hall, I forget what I've read or the question was twisted such that I don't know how to answer it?*

***A**: Simple. Don't just read for exams. Answer questions. This way, you would have come across different ways questions could be twisted & learned how to answer them!*

A few years after graduation, I went back to OAU to a place called Yellow House to see a lecturer. On my way up, three students ran after me asking…



"Are you Tolulope Ahmed?"

"Yes, I am," I said.

"Wow, WE'VE BEEN LOOKING FOR YOU! There's a physics question that we've not been able to solve. We've taken it to several tutorial centres, but they couldn't solve it. But we heard that you're a first-class graduate of Physics, and when we saw you, we brought it for you to solve for us," one of them said.

At first, I was thinking *"Am I being set up? Is this a prank? Are they trying to disgrace my first class?"* But then, I thought *"Las, las, if I can't solve it, I'll tell them 'I'm coming back!'"* 😁

The first thing I noticed when I checked the question was that the question was *wrong*. So, I corrected it, and then I solved it.

"Wow! He's a genius!" One of them said.

And in my mind, I was just thinking, *"I'm not seeing the genius anywhere. It's just that for over 4 years on campus I answered thousands of physics questions, and this question didn't look like one of those questions. So, I turned it into one of those questions, and then I solved it!"* It was just my experience in play.

Again, people will call you genius, amazing, brilliant, etc. Those are names that they've fashioned to describe the things that they don't understand.

> *Remember, the way to get to excellence is to practice, practice, practice until one day it becomes automatic.*

Answering Questions Give You Direction!

If you are in a university/polytechnic or writing a professional exam, you will realize that most questions in textbooks are not as specific as the collection of past questions on the course. This is because the questions in the textbooks were designed for general use. The authors were not exactly thinking about your programme when they wrote their books. So, questions in textbooks may not be specific to your course, but past questions are.

The only time textbooks may be very specific is if they are part of the recommended texts. Though, in providing answers to questions, you might also be led to a textbook.

> *KEY IDEA: The number of questions you can answer in your course tells you **how much you know** about that course.*

The Questions are the Answers

The average student just reads—no past question, no direction. You should always study your notes together with the past questions. In fact, study the questions first.

When you have enough questions in your heart before studying, you become thirstier and hungrier for SPECIFIC knowledge than if you don't—your RAS becomes activated to filter the right answers to your attention. Someone summarized it this way: the questions are the answers.

Answering Questions Makes Studying Interesting

Students frequently ask me the question: "I find it interesting to read any other types of books: spiritual, relationship, leadership, etc. but reading my academic notes is usually boring. What do I do?" And the answer is simple:

> *"Answer questions! Don't just read. Ensure your study time is for answering questions and not just reading!"*

Studying is boring without Q&As. Have you ever noticed that during seminars, it is the "Question and Answer" session that is the most interesting, captivating and the most empowering period? Yes!

Not "How Long" but "How Many Questions You Answer"

People ask me, how many hours should a person study?

> *"The number of hours you spend studying is not important! What is important is how many questions you can answer".*

And guess what? If you ensure that "your study period = question and answer period", then you can even study for several unmonitored hours without losing enthusiasm! Try it and see!

The Number of Questions Answered Tells Your Progress

> *The way you **measure** your learning progress is not really "how many pages you've read", but "how many questions you've answered (or can answer) compared to the average PQ."*

Are you able to pass only 20% of the average PQ? Then you're 20% good. Can you answer 70% of the average PQ? Then you've made 70% progress, and so on.

If you have 1 hour in between lectures, one of the best ways to maximize that 1 hour is *"how many questions you can answer within that hour."* Plus, it's an effective way to manage your time and make significant progress in a short time.

If you have to study with a group, the best way to maximize the study time is *"how many questions you can answer in that study group in the designated time."* It can help the group to focus and everybody gains! If you are in a place that could get you distracted (but you don't have a choice…like your room), keep yourself focused by answering questions only within the time.

Did you notice that this already suggests that you should always have questions with you anytime you want to study?

> ***Think About It**: On the day of the exam, you will be required to answer some set of questions, won't you? Therefore, the best way to excellently answer the questions is to become very good at it, by answering many questions now.*

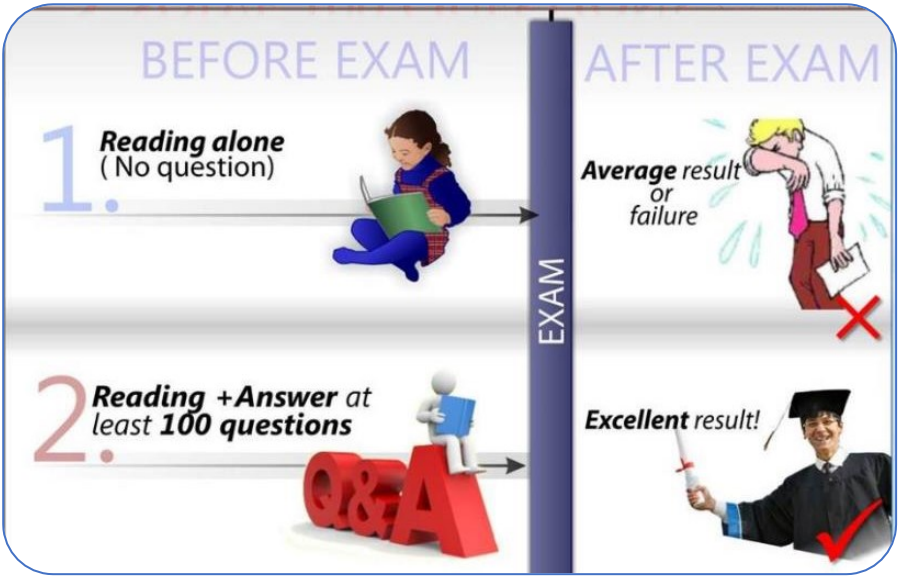
More Applications to Academics

1. Start answering questions long before the semester starts.
2. Study PQs even before classes, so while the class is going on, some things the lecturer says will be the answers to the questions in your

heart and you will enjoy the class more than someone who didn't study questions before the class. (Your RAS will call those answers to your attention while others see it as an info dump you see answers.

3. Ensure Your "Study Periods" are "Q&A Periods." When you go to the library, ask yourself: "How many questions will I answer before I come out of this library?"
4. Answer at least 30 questions per day!

Before the Exam, Answer at least 100 Questions



> *"IF ALL YOU DO from today till the day of your exam is answer past questions every single day, then there's a high chance you'll answer all the questions in the exam & score 100%!*

How to Study Past Questions

This is a very important and sensitive part of this chapter. Most people just study and answer past questions anyhow. But here, I am

suggesting a better and more effective way of studying past questions:

1. Get a separate notebook (not sheets of paper), preferably a higher education and label it 'Questions and answers'.
2. Then write both the (past) questions and the answers inside it. E.g.,

1. **What is the difference between selling and marketing?** (The PQ)
   Selling is simply the act of exchanging a product or service for money while Marketing is the act of building a brand in the mind of the prospective customers such that when they think of solving their problems they think first about your product. (The Answer)
2. **Hence, what are the 5 indispensable steps to successful selling?**
   This is known as the AIDCA principle:
   Attract Attention—Let an influential person introduce your product
   Develop Interest—mention immediately the irresistible benefits
   Inspire Desire—connect the product to their needs
   Create Conviction—mention the product's guarantee
   Incite Action—make the person buy the product...
3. ...

This can go on and on. The key Idea is that you should keep a record of your solved past questions. Why? So that these "documented Q&As" become **Review Material** for the entire course/subject towards your final exams (no matter how voluminous it is).

This is a very good way of studying with direction and retaining the knowledge. By so doing, you learn so much in so little time. I practised this consistently and it really accelerated my preparation and ultimately my academic results.

How to become Very Good at a Course you don't like

> *"If you want to become very good at a particular course (e.g. Maths), then you need to push yourself to answer at least 100 questions per topic in the course before the exam."*

The More You Answer Questions, The More You Know it

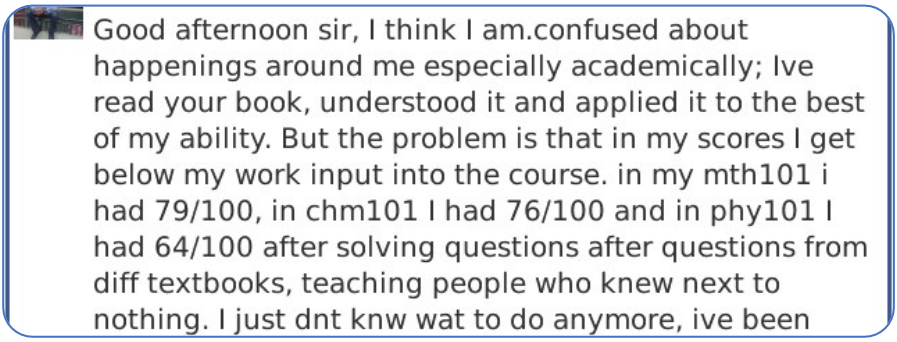
Therefore, assuming I have a challenge with Mathematics if I can answer 100 questions (per topic), I will become quite good at it. The same goes for other courses. Try it and see!

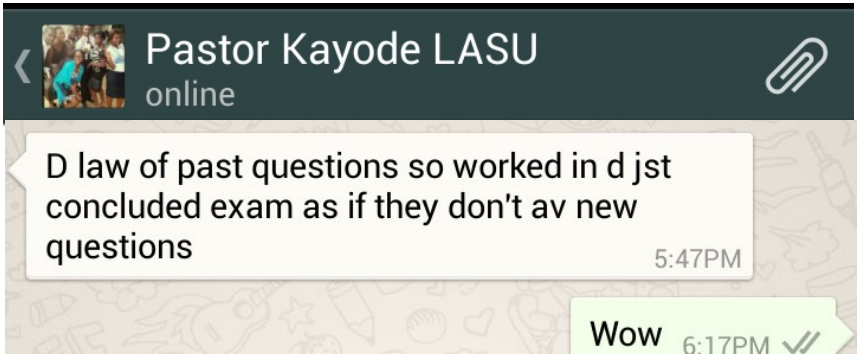
How to get BONUS marks when answering questions

1. Use diagrams and figures to answer questions where possible.
2. Use *several methods* to answer a question and arrive at *the same answer*.
3. In math equations, check your answers. Show that LHS = RHS

Testimonies

Remember I shared Mayowa's testimony with you in chapter 2 (see page 20). Well, as you see above, the other part of his testimony is that he achieved his results by answering plenty of PQs. Kayode too.





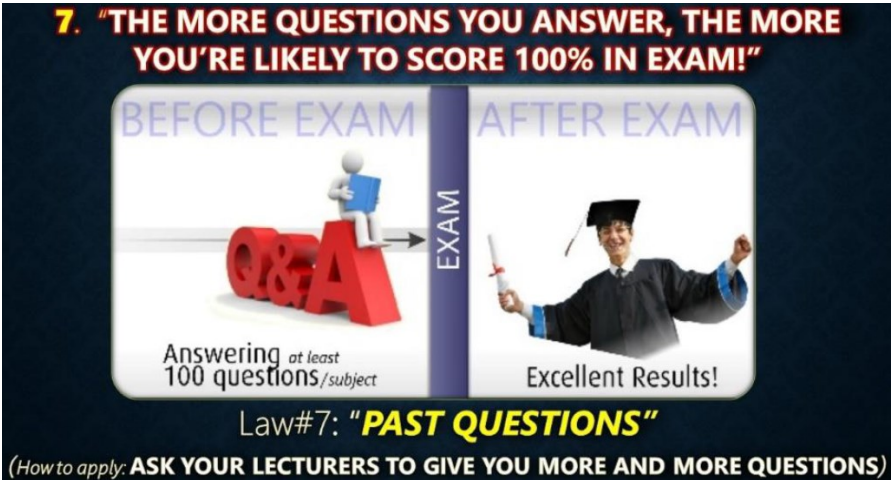
FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #6– (NEXT FAQ: PAGE 67)

***Q**: Sir, you told us to replace the word "reading" with the phrase "answering questions." But how can we start answering questions when we haven't read first? Shouldn't we read first before answering the questions?*

***A**: Yes, you should always start with the questions first. Then in the process of trying to answer the questions, **YOU WILL READ the right things**. Your RAS will help you see the information as answers and not just an information dump. So, yes, questions first, the **right reading** after.*

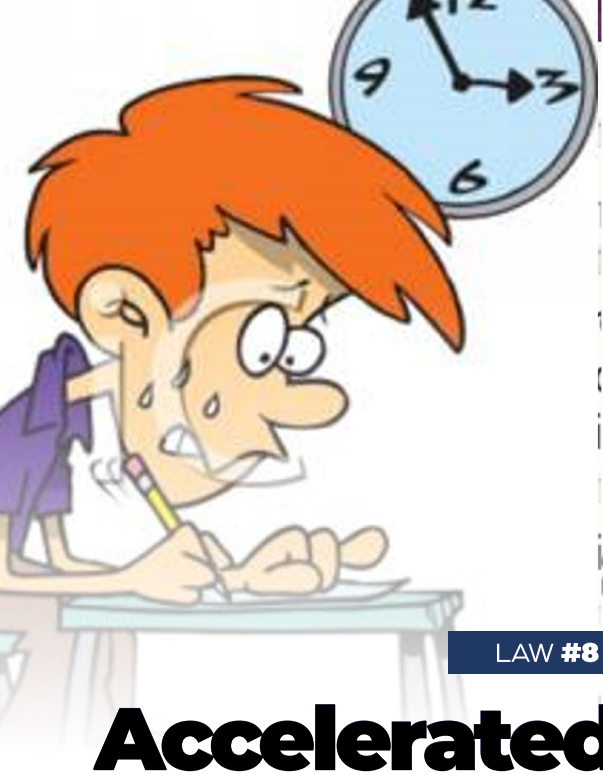
In Summary…

> *From henceforth, replace the word "**reading**" with the phrase "**answering questions**." The more questions you answer the more you read the right things and develop the capacity to answer more questions.*



3 Quick Questions

1. Why is it better to start with the PQs before reading?
2. What do you do if you don't have access to past questions? (see FAQ #3)
3. How can one become very good at a course one's not currently good at?



LAW **#8**

Accelerated Learning

"The best way to prepare for any exam is by doing more self-tests!"

*"Until your self-tests begin to yield **high scores**, do not assume that you're ready yet for any exam."*

ACCELERATED LEARNING IS THE IDEA THAT "IF YOU MAKE WHAT you are learning **not only come into you but also go out from you,** you're learning fast!"

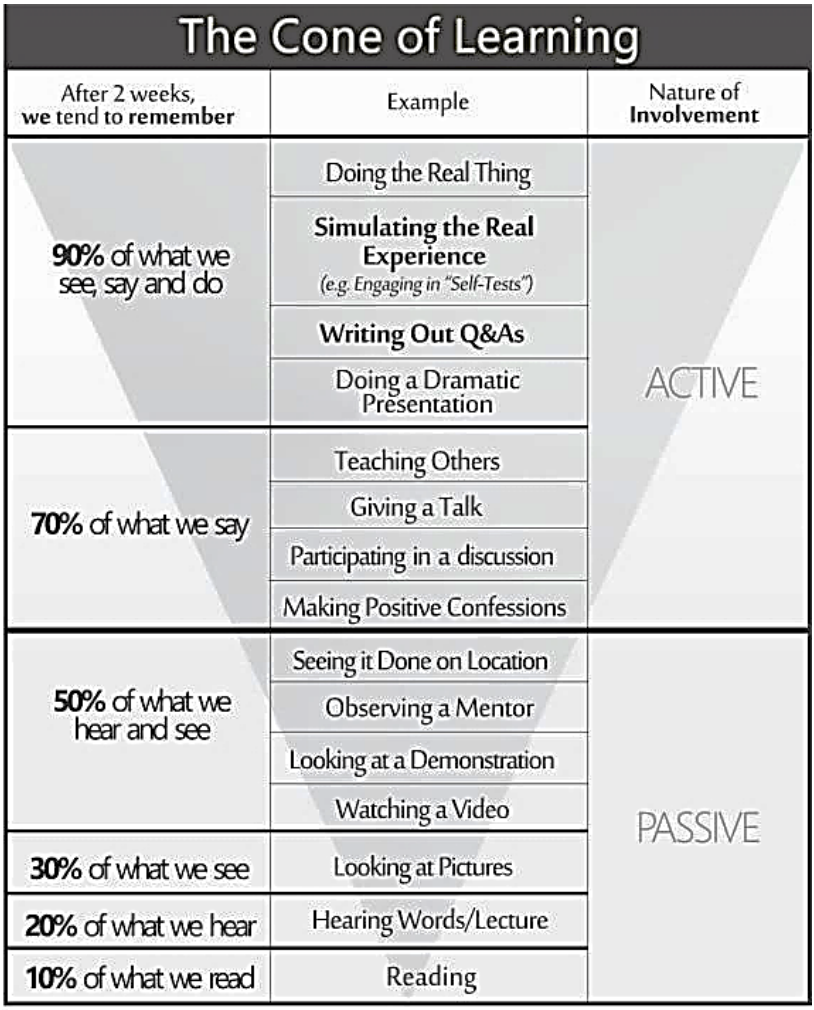
This chapter simply says, "You learn better, easier and faster when you involve several parts of your body in learning." For example,

1. when you teach your friend how to solve a math question, you're learning that Math question better.
2. when you give yourself self-tests, grade yourself and then learn from your corrections, you're learning that course better.

> *"85% of what we learn is visual, 14% of what we learn is audible (or auditory) and 1% from other sources."* — ***Research***

The Cone of Learning—*you learn best by doing*

> *We remember about 10% of what we read, 20% of what we hear, 30% of what we see, 60% of what we say, 70% of what we do* ***and 90% of what we hear, see, say and do***.



From *"Audio-Visual Methods in Teaching"* (3rd Edition) by Edgar Dale, 1969.

So, you get information primarily by what you see and what you hear; but to internalize it (in so little time), you need to engage your eyes, your ears, your mouth, your thoughts and your actions, in the learning process.

The Second-Best Way to Learn—*self-test (and the solutions)*

As you can see from THE CONE OF LEARNING, the worst way to learn is "reading" (10% recall) and the second worst way is by "listening to a lecture" (20%)—which unfortunately, are the two most popular ways *many* learn in traditional schools. Not you!

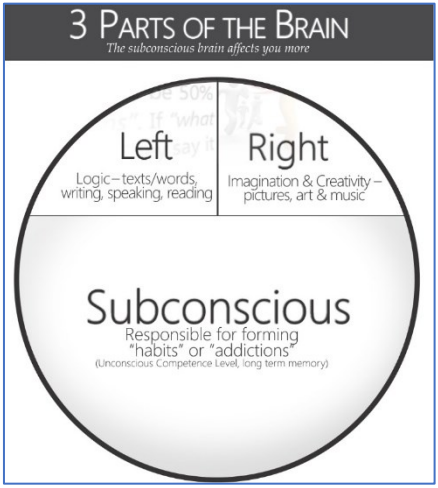
At the top of the cone is "DOING THE REAL THING" (90% recall). Meaning "people learn best by doing the real thing". However, we see that just below "REAL LIFE LEARNING" is "SIMULATIONS" (i.e. **self-tests** or **pretending to be doing the real thing**). Here, the real thing is the exam but, since you can't wait for that, so we can say that…

> *"The best way to learn & prepare for exams is by giving yourself self-tests **till they begin to yield high scores**."*

Get a past question, time yourself with the time on it, and do it as an exam. Grade yourself at the end of the self-test. [You may want to do this with a partner so that you can keep yourselves accountable and resist the temptation of not going through with the self-test till the end]. It will amaze you how fast you retain the subject.

How it Works—*The 3 Parts of The Brain (or the 3 "Brains")*

1. **The Left Brain:** This part of the brain processes logic—writing, reading, and speaking. Associated with academic intelligence. The male brain has more tendencies here.
2. **The Right Brain:** This part is intuitive, emotional, and non-linear. Associated with spatial intelligence. The female brain has more tendencies here.
3. **The Subconscious Brain:** This is the most powerful of all 3 brains. *It is not logical. It does not think but rather* ***reacts*** *(flees, fights, freezes, etc.)*, especially under pressure. And the reaction is based on whatever has been programmed into it via the left and right brains beforehand. It is responsible for *your habits, excellence, autopilot, addictions, beliefs*, etc.



The Mind Thinks in Pictures! —*so use pictures in exams.*

This is why you also dream in pictures (and not in words). We can use this to our advantage: That's why you need to use figures/diagrams to answer questions in the exam.

3 WAYS TO APPLY ACCELERATED LEARNING

1. **Ensure your Study Periods = Q&A Periods:** We covered this in the last chapter. You need to answer questions every day, even if it's the same set of questions. The more you answer a question, the more it becomes permanent knowledge.

> *Rule: While studying, don't just read; answer questions. This will tell you what to read. This is the first technique that makes you learn fast.*

2. **Teach Someone Else:** When you teach, you learn in a *multisensory* way. Teaching makes you experience the knowledge. And when the person you have taught is also competent [very good] like you, then you have "owned" the knowledge.

> *It's been said that the **5th Stage of learning** after unconscious competence is "to be able to teach someone else to become unconsciously competent."*

"Teaching a subject is the highest level of understanding". When you teach, you help your friend and also help yourself.

> *You cannot say you've understood something until you can teach someone else so that he/she understands it.*

Also writing something down as you teach the person helps you both. In the final analysis, you become what you teach. "You learn more by doing what you're learning than by teaching it—and that makes you a better teacher of it!" Learn, Do, then Teach!

3. **Give Yourself Self-tests as often as possible:** According to the Cone of Learning, giving yourself self-tests is the best way to learn, retain your knowledge and effectively prepare for exams.

   Call a friend, get a past question, time yourselves, and do the questions together. Then mark and grade yourselves. And then learn the corrections to the questions you failed. Then do it again! Do this often. It'll amaze you how fast and interesting your learning becomes.

Self-Test Develops Your 3 Brains!

This process educates and develops all three "brains"—especially the subconscious brain. The left and right brains are involved in providing answers to the question while the subconscious mind is more or less neutral.

Though the subconscious brain is reactive, it shifts away from being fearful of failure to being excited at the joy of learning because it's only a simulation. So, "the fear of failure" diminishes and you ultimately become more confident as the exam approaches. The reverse is the case for most students who do engage in self-tests—students who do not educate the subconscious brain. Not you!

How to Easily Memorize—*repeatedly write what you want to memorize*

For example: To memorize a formula, repeatedly write the formula on a sheet of paper. Then take another sheet (or open another

page), and repeatedly write it again and again from memory. By the time you've rewritten the formula, say 50 times, it can become permanent in the memory. Most of us probably learned the Quadratic Formula that way!

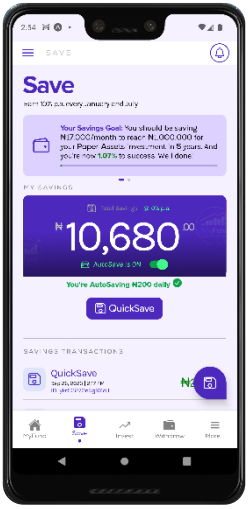
Exam Success Strategies During Exams

1. **Always aim to use figures/diagrams to answer questions**: You get extra marks for using figures as answers sometimes.
2. **Use legible/readable handwriting**: It could take months before you develop it. It can earn you *favour*. The only occasion when illegibility pays is when you are not sure of the spelling of a word, so you smudge the letters so that the examiner gives you the benefit of the doubt or fails to notice the error. 😁 This is wisdom.
3. **Write SHORT easily understandable sentences**: Apply Rules of Communication. When you write, remember that the examiners are not just logical but also EMOTIONAL beings. So, appeal to their emotions. Long sentences may frustrate the examiner. Instead of writing *"due to the fact that"* write *"because."* Instead of *"in the event of"* just say *"if"*, etc.
4. **Format your work:** Underline, bold, or bracket for clarity where possible. You can use tables, etc. If allowed, you can also put your key points (or equations or final answer) in a box.

More...

5. **Turn your phone into a learning device**: Download dictionaries, thesauruses, the periodic table, etc. that give you quick information. Listen to messages/audiobooks, etc. Sometimes, just your PHONE

AND EARPIECE can be what will help you grow fast; mentally and spiritually. You can even listen to training or selected podcasts for growth while walking, working, cooking, ironing, washing, commuting, etc. It's amazing.



6. **Use the internet productively.** Learn skills and get professional certifications from global companies via coursera.org, udemy.com, etc. For example, I became a *full stack developer* with Pro Certifications from Meta for Frontend, Backend and Database Engineering WITHIN 8 MONTHS, using the accelerated learning techniques in this book. You can as well!

Testimony

> *"Sir, last year, you told me to dream of scoring 400/400 in UTME. I have never heard anyone dream that big or talk that way before. This infused a force into me, that I scored 284/400 despite the mass failure, I even got 96% in Physics, because the SELF-TESTS method you gave me drove me to do extra study in Physics."— **BIODUN ILESANMI, OAU** (2014)*

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #7– (NEXT FAQ: PAGE 73)

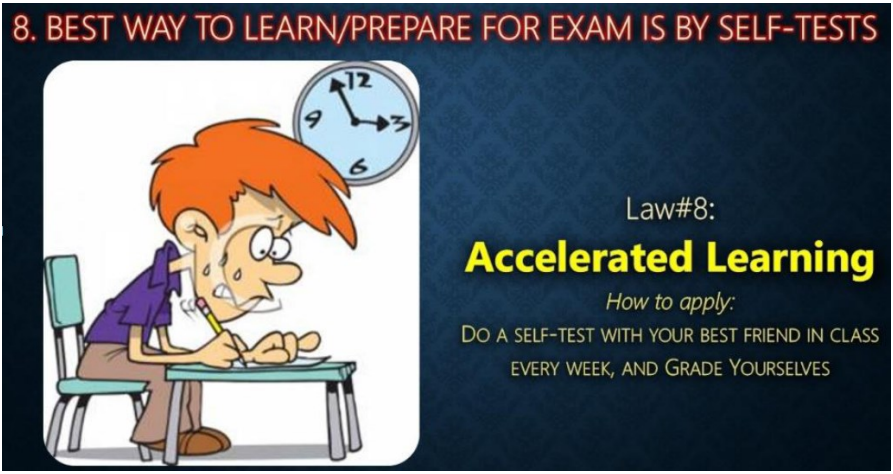
***Q**: Sir, is it effective to read overnight?*

***A**: No. It is not. The reason is that the brain is not very active at night compared with day. Scientific research says the best time to go to bed is 10 pm.*

***Secondly**, during sleep, two important things happen:*
i. Your body fights diseases and makes you healthier.
ii. Your mind works during sleep to store information better. So, sleeping at night is very important for your HEALTH and LEARNING!

In Summary...

> *From henceforth, replace the word "**studying**" with the phrase "**doing self-tests**." When your self-tests are beginning to yield high scores in the average PQs, then you know you're ready for the exam and you're likely to score 100% in it.*



3 Quick Questions

1. Do you recall what is the best way to prepare for exams?
2. What is the *indicator* that you're ready (or not) for an exam?
3. Which is more effective in preparing for exams?
   (i.) Reading the entire note before taking self-tests as practice.
   (ii.) Taking self-tests first, self-correcting, and taking another one again.

LAW **#9**

Academic Mentoring

"Learn from the best lecturers and excellent students in your department."

"A journey is very good when you have a map but better and fun when you have someone who has worked the path successfully before, showing you the way."

RESPECT EXPERIENCE! MANY THINGS THAT ARE NEW TO YOU ARE very old. What is "revelation" to you has been "basic knowledge" to someone else for years. Ask. Talk. Get counsels.

Successful people still constantly get counsel. King Solomon said, *"Become wise by walking with wise people; hang out with fools and watch your life fall to pieces."* (Prov. 13:22). If you want to be rich, walk with the rich; if you want to be the best, walk with the best.

Another Way to Quickly Become Excellent

Recall, from THE 4 STAGES OF LEARNING, the way to get to the unconscious competence level is to practise, practise, practise, practise, practise, and practise until you become excellent.

> *The second way to quickly get to the unconscious competence level is to **constantly observe** someone who is already unconsciously competent at it.*

Our brains are divinely designed to imitate what they see others do — and this happens all the time! In simple terms, the brain works like *monkey see, monkey do*.

Influence Happens Automatically—*you're a product of influence*

See, you have no control over the influence on you. But by consciously deciding to get the right people to associate with, you decide the influence on you and you change your life. Close up with the best lecturers and excellent senior colleagues in your department, they will influence your thinking and change your results with time. Close up with me online as well.

> *"Just like a tree draws the nutrients around it to grow, we also tend to absorb the paradigms, mental models, thought patterns, and behaviours of happenings in our environment—without even knowing it!"*

Get Into the Right Company

We established in LAW 1 that *when* your goals for academic excellence are truly set and clear, you *will* find yourself among the top people in your class, otherwise, you will find yourself among the remaining part of the class. ***This is the first step to getting into the right company****—very clear goals.*

The further step is to associate with people ahead of you who are already academically excellent in the programme that you are doing. No matter how many principles you apply, if you lack the

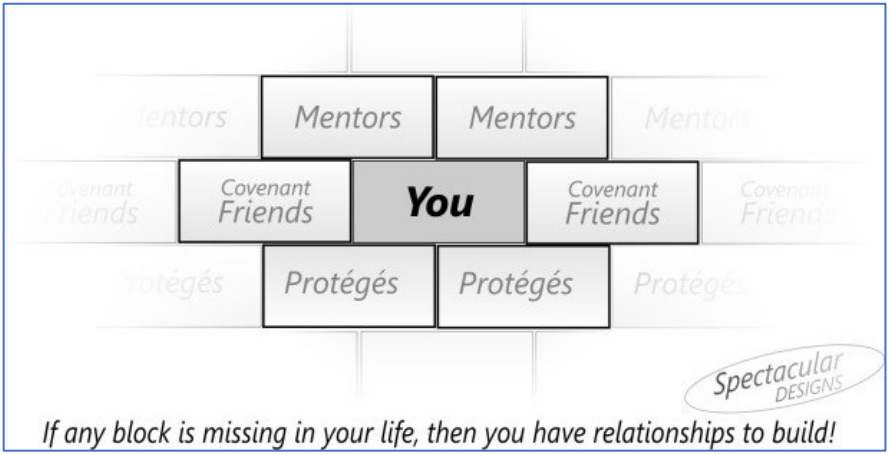
right company, you won't move forward. Your academic performance is largely due to the people with whom you associate.

> *"You are the same person today that you are going to be in 5 years except for two things: The books you read and the people you associate with" (Charles 'Tremendous' Jones).*

This means that two things determine your tomorrow—books and people around you. If you read every day and associate consciously with excellent people with focus/vision and people with leadership ability, your life will be on the increase every day and your tomorrow is guaranteed (even without conscious effort from you).

Now, imagine people with a POOR association and NO reading; then they have made a joke of their futures!

3 Blocks of Relationship for Constant Progress



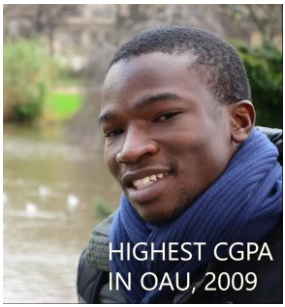
1. **MENTORS**: People ahead of you who already have in their lives what you desire. They give you a "reality check" for your progress. Remember Basic Concept #1: WHO DO YOU LISTEN TO?

2. **COVENANT FRIENDS**: Friends who can share your problems and double your successes. This relationship brings you closer to God. And you can get instant support from them!
3. **PROTÉGÉS/MENTEES**: People whose lives are influenced by yours. People in whom you replicate the [academic] results you get from your [academic] mentors. Remember, a successful person without a successor is only a failure in disguise.

Get an Academic Mentor

Notice you do *not* need to verbally ask the person to be your academic mentor. To get a mentor, simply go to him/her from time to time! It will amaze you to discover that **true mentoring** is 70% of the protégé's activities and about 30% of the mentor's activities!

Your Mentor Should Have Your Desired Result



I studied Engineering Physics. My academic mentor (Tope Onanuga) finished as the best student in the university (2009) while I graduated as the best student in the Faculty of Science, OAU (2010). Also, on the endorsement page of this book, you'll see testimonies of people I mentored. They graduated with first-class in the same department; mainly because it was easy for me to take them through the same system I went through successfully.

But if you're reading this and not in that (physics) department, then you need to close up with the best in *your* department who can provide that same mentoring for you—i.e. replicate their results in you. Remember, Academics have standards (LAW 3), and that

person ahead of you who has excellent grades understands those standards more than you.

Use our website and social media to join our online mentoring!

If you consciously apply the principle of the 3 blocks of relationships above, you will steadily continue to grow ahead of your peers in academics, life and destiny. You would sharpen your focus and could outgrow your age in maturity. Try it and see!

Replicate Your Academic Results in Junior Students

Package the solutions to the PQs for younger colleagues. You will even profit financially by helping other people succeed academically. If your PQ&As have helped you, they will help others as well. And guess what? You will be thanked and remembered for it long after you've graduated. If you want to publish/print it, buzz me directly on WhatsApp or fill out this form: http://bit.ly/vpublishing.

> *"A successful person without a successor is only a failure in disguise."*

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTION #8– (NEXT FAQ: PAGE 6)

***Q**: Sir, I think all these principles only work for people who are in the sciences; those who do calculation questions. For someone like me in the Law/English department where we need to compose theories to answer questions, I don't really see how it applies.*

***A**: Perhaps there may be more application to the Sciences than the Arts, etc. However, if you apply the idea of mentoring here, you will learn specific things from excellent senior colleagues that apply to Law and the Arts that this book may not have provided specifically.*

So close up with the best students in your department, and your academic excellence becomes close to you. In my experience, you will

> ***always learn more than what you expect from them when you engage them. Departmental fellowships, symposiums, or their rooms*** *are some of the best places to meet them.*
>
> *So, always learn from (and share with) the geniuses of your department...because you're also one.*

In Summary...

> *If all the success principles in the world can be summarized into one word, that word will be "**mentoring**!"*

3 Quick Questions

1. How do you know who should be your mentor?
2. What are the three blocks of relationship that guarantee progress in life? Which of them do you need to get?
3. How do you get a mentor?

ESTABLISHING YOUR ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE

LAW **#10**

Positive Confessions

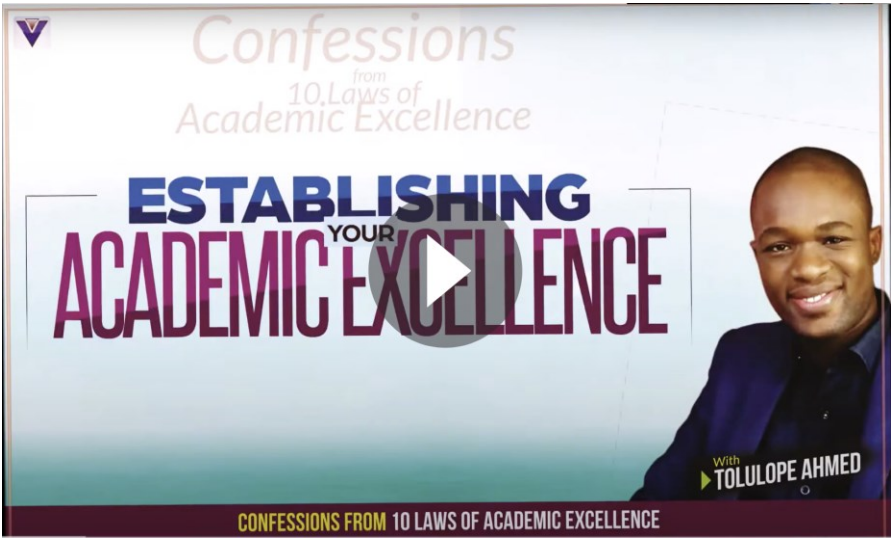
"Your words will become your results!"

> *"Your words are **indicators** of what is about to happen in your life. They show you what you're thinking and also help focus your thoughts. Your words will become flesh!"*

FIRST OF ALL, PLEASE TAKE A LITTLE TIME TO DOWNLOAD THE video (and audio) for this chapter titled "ESTABLISHING YOUR ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE." It is a summary of the main concepts of this book but as a confession.

Remember *"If you make what you are learning not only come into you but also go out from you, you're learning fast!"* Even scripture says…

> *"People can get many good things by the words they say. Your words may seem of no effect, but they can ACCOMPLISH/DESTROY almost ANYTHING"*[1]



Watch at…

> *https://bit.ly/10lawsEstablish*

You Become What You Constantly Say!

> *Just observe people around you and far away and you will notice that he who speaks most of the problem has it; he who speaks most of prosperity has it, he who speaks most of wisdom has it. Same way, he who speaks most of academic excellence, has it.*

Don't Try to Negate the Negative – *just speak positively*

Don't pray that something negative will not happen, because it still makes you think of failure. Instead, just pray that positive things will happen. (So, you always think success)

> *Don't say, "May I not fail my exams in Jesus' Name" Instead, simply say, "Thank you Lord because I'm the best in class this session.*

What you focus on, GROWS! – *focus on the positive*

The reason why you must focus on the positive is because what you focus on, expands.

If you say, "May I not fail any of my exams". You are saying, it's okay to score 40E, 45D, 50C, etc. That's what it means not to fail. Because you're still focusing on failure—subconsciously.

But if you pray, "May I score 100% in all my exams", then you're focusing on the positive, and it will most likely happen that way. Remember, "Whatever you focus on, GROWS!"

Positive Confessions for Academics! *– focus on the positive*

Long before exams, constantly say things like:

> *"I'm an extraordinary person; I'm a child of God. Every necessary material I need to work out excellence in my academics comes my way. Every important person I need to meet, I come across them and I'm sensitive to know them when I meet them in Jesus' Name.*
>
> *I have a blessed memory. I am a teacher to my mates. I am rich and healthy. I walk in excellence; my name cannot be found under grades like **F**, **E**, **D**, **C** or **B**. But people will talk about me when they hear **A**s. I am complete in Christ.*
>
> *Just like Solomon answered all the questions of the queen of Sheeba, I proffer accurate answers to all questions brought before me because I am the excellent one in whom is the LORD's delight.*
>
> *For the Lord God will help me; therefore, I shall not be confounded: therefore, have I set my face like a flint, and I KNOW that I shall not be ashamed, etc."*

Remember, everything is created twice. Life is first of all spiritual before it is physical. Words are also spiritual.

> *Never say, "The course I'm studying is difficult!" or "I am not good at [Mathematics, Chemistry, etc.]" or "My lecturers are wicked", etc., instead say... "My course is simple", "I'm good at this!", "I can do this" and "If it is to be, it is up to me."*

Your Words = Your Thoughts Externalized

Any word out of your mouth is a direct result of what you have filled your heart [or your mind] with. If you fill your heart [or watch] soap opera, you will speak soap opera. If you fill your heart with football, you will automatically speak football. If all you see, watch, hear and think about are problems, failures and bad news, you'll speak about problems, failures and bad news.

But if you fill your heart with excellent things, God's Word, inspirational quotes, etc., you will naturally and automatically speak and do excellent things. First in mind, then in reality.

Divine Directives—*How to study with Divine direction for exams*

> *"A man plans his steps, but God directs his path."*
> *(Solomon, Proverbs 16:9)*

To get exceptional and unexplainable results, you need Divine Directives. There is a God factor involved in academics. Even if you know what to do, you need the divine directives and guidance of God to know when and how to do it for unexplainable results.

5 Ways to Hear from God

1. **Through Bible Direct!** A direct quote from God's Word guides you on the things you seek. You can't be led by the Spirit without knowing the Word and talking to Him in prayer.
2. **Through your renewed mind** (inner witness). If you study the Word a lot, when God speaks, it will come to you as an inspired thought. You will meet God through your thinking life.
3. **Through Anointed Books on what you need.** For academics, for example, you can get 10 LAWS OF ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE because they are in line with the Truth of God's Word.
4. **Through Collection of wise sayings** (or Quotes). Bible says…

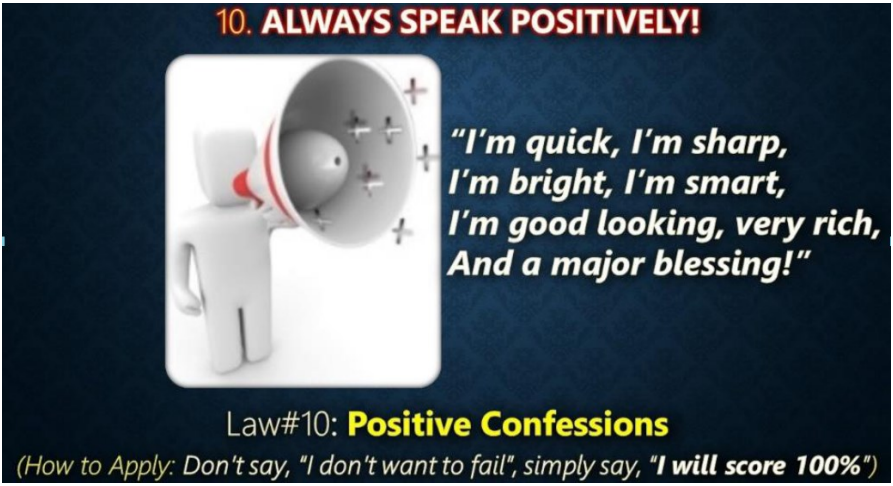
> *'The collected sayings of the wise are like guidance'*[3]

Write quotes *at the top of every page of your notes*; you'll grow wise.

5. **Base on Your Relationship with God**. Based on how God has led you in the past especially if you've come to trust that process over the years and if those things are consistent with kingdom principles summarized in *love, justice, righteousness, mercy and truth.*

In Summary…

> *"Your words are indicators of what is in the process of manifesting in your life!"*



3 Quick Questions

4. Why is important not to negate the negative, but instead speak positively?
5. Why is it important to focus on the positive at all times?
6. If your classmates are complaining about a course, how will you respond positively and not join them to speak negatively?

#11

Exam Tips

"When your self-tests yield high scores, then you're ready for the exam!"

"Document solutions to past/likely questions daily throughout the semester for you to practice/review them for the exam."

BY NOW, YOU KNOW THAT EXAM PERIODS ARE NOT WHEN YOU start preparing for exams. The opening quote in this chapter is perhaps the summary or central pillar of this book. Exam tips neither begin in the exam hall nor during exam periods. It starts before the new session.

Before a New Session — Write down all your goals.

Write a master plan for other activities you will be involved in— if you are serving as a leader in an organization/association, sit down, meditate and create a plan for the whole semester or session. This makes your life easier. It will make you automatically know what to do next. The best way to predict the future is to create it.

- ✓ **Create your academic goal**—see Law 1
- ✓ **Collect relevant materials**—Contact/call your senior colleagues who have just finished what you are about to start (since there

is nothing new under the sun) and collect (what I call) relevant materials. Relevant materials in this order include:

b. Practice, past or tutorial questions from lecturers,
c. Past questions available on the course,
d. Material that solved past questions on your subject/courses,
e. Class notes of your senior colleagues,
f. Recommended textbooks *(including their questions and answers)*

Tests are as important as exams—*prepare for them very early*

Tests or continuous assessments are (if not more) as important as exams. If you don't do excellently well in your tests, you will struggle for marks in your exam. That's why you should keep getting questions from your lecturers to answer throughout the semester.

Preparing for Exams—*Do more Q&As and self-tests*

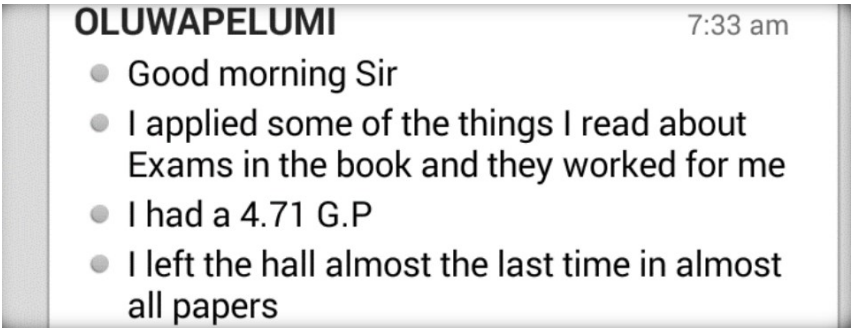
1. **An effective way to start your day**—*take your bath very early*. As long as you've not taken your bath, you subconsciously feel that you're not ready to start your day.
2. **Eat Well, Never Miss Your Breakfast**. Nutritionists say that breakfast is the most important meal of the day—more important than lunch and dinner—and is ideal between 7 and 7:30 am or thereabout. Breakfast keeps the mind sharp throughout the first half of the day. Your health is vital. Fasting on the day of the exam doesn't make the brain smarter! Also, take lots of water—it hydrates the body and cleanses your system. #LAW8
3. **Aim to Score 100%**. It's not *"do your best and leave the rest"* but *"do everything and leave nothing!"* Recall, that you're already excellent! (LAW 2). Maintain Confessing Excellence. Say, "I have 100%."
4. **Make sure that your "Study Periods" = "Q&A Periods".** Always answer questions whether or not the subject is Math, Accounting or Law. "The questions are the answers." #LAW7

*ANSWER **AT LEAST 100 QUESTIONS** PER COURSE BEFORE EXAMS*

5. **Practice Giving Yourself Several "SELF-TESTS".** This is the best way to learn fast and prepare for exams. Do it with a friend. It makes it more fun and empowering. This is the only way to measure and improve your exam speed. #LAW8

During the Exam—*Exam tips!*

6. **Obey all instructions**: "Do whatever they tell you to do!" #LAW3
7. **Work to get bonus marks**: If it is a Math-related exam, use different methods to do the same question. Always check your answers by proving that LHS = RHS, when solving equations.
8. **Where possible, aim to use images, graphs, Figures and illustrations to answer questions** (if allowed): Do this especially if you don't have good handwriting. #LAW8
9. **Do not submit until the time is up**. Double check, triple check. Aim for 100%. Even if you've "finished" the exam before time, continue to improve it until "time up". Most of the time you will certainly find some areas you either need to correct or improve. Listen *"Creativity" is another word for "improvement"*. Dot your **i**'s and cross your **t**'s. Do an excellent job that deserves 100%. #LAW2.



Student of Lagos State University (LASU), Lagos, Nigeria.

#12

7 Ways to Make Money

"The first evidence of financial intelligence is your ability to make money!"

*"The first discipline in finances is to **increase your income streams** until your income (I) is more than your expenses (E) per month. Without monthly surplus, you can't make financial progress which consequently affects other areas of your life—including academics."*

THE FIRST EVIDENCE OF FINANCIAL INTELLIGENCE IS TO MAKE income. The second is to ***set up and manage an "escrow savings account."*** The third and final discipline is to acquire assets that yield continuous or passive income.

We're only going to focus on the first financial discipline here for this book. For more, download the MyFund app or sign up at…

> *www.myfundmobile.com/register*

Value Out = Cash In

First, bury it in your mind that "money should only come into your hands after you've given out value!" (Diagram). There's no such thing as something for nothing.

> *The key to earning anything is "**trade**" or "**exchange**".*

Either offer a product or service (via your skills/expertise, etc.) or information (data—e-books, audios, etc.). But there must be "trade". It's value for cash! Nothing more, nothing less. We would have cheated you if the value you're getting in this book is not equal to (or more than) the cash you paid for it.

> *"Money is either created or earned" (Sunday Adelaja).*

And, more value out = more cash in! Someone once defined…

$$Wealth = V \times N$$

Where V = *value*, and N = *the number of people you can offer the value.*

The 5 General Ways to Earn Money

These are the 5 income sources that feature in the income column of your financial statement. The first 4 are active income streams. The 5th is passive.

1. **SALARY**—i.e. *You work for a business and you're paid.* The challenge here usually is that you sacrifice your time in the process. And a wrong mindset about money could be formed. (e.g. "I'm getting richer when my salary increases", etc.)

> ***Paradigm Shift:*** *"Your Goal is NOT Financial Security (or high-paying job)!" Your true financial goal is to be Financially Free* ($PI > E$)

2. **GIFTS**—Allowances *(from parents or husband/fiancé)*, Honorariums for Speakers, Ministers, Pastors, Entertainers (or comedians), etc.

3. **DEALS**: i.e. Trading *(Buying & Selling)*, Referrals, Exchanges or Rentals.

4. **BUSINESS** *(or Entrepreneurship):* You create your own product/service, employ employees to sell, pay them salary, and profit from net sales.

5. **INCOME FROM INVESTMENTS** *(or passive income):* They are income from assets. This is by far the best way to earn. It's the income that sets free: e.g. Rent, Dividends, Director's bonus, Royalties, MLM Bonuses.

By God's Grace, I enjoy income from all the streams listed above, and a little passive. But it has taken, effort and consistency to build these streams. But they work! Here are **6 ideas** you can apply!

1. Develop a Skill and Offer it as a Service!

You already know how to develop a skill. It's by practising and practising and practising… until one day, you realize you're doing it automatically. Go to coursera.org, LinkedIn learning, etc. to get professional training with certifications like I did to become a full-stack developer/engineer. Typing, Teaching skills, Graphic/Web Design, Catering, People Management Skills, Leadership Skills, etc.

2. Package Your PQ & Solutions for Younger Colleagues

This is one way to replicate your results in others; and profit from it. Do you recall the statement I said is the central pillar of this book?

> *"Document solutions to past/likely questions daily throughout the semester for you to practice/review them for the exam."*

Yes, ***turn it into material that solved past questions*** for younger colleagues. Target courses with large markets. When you're ready to publish, buzz me on WhatsApp or fill out this form to receive an estimate by email:

> ***ValuePlus Publishing****: http://bit.ly/vpublishing*

3. Save up to Buy Things You Can Rent Out

Projectors and Screens, Generators, Musical Instruments, Events instruments (Lights and Sounds), Cameras, Chairs and Canopies, Cooking Utensils, etc. Look in your environment to see what has rental value!

4. Do a Part-time Job – *(start a business on the side)*

Generally, I do not recommend a full-time job that takes the whole of a person's time mainly because it stands in your way of being able to do other important productive things—like building extra income streams, personal/skill development/education, attending seminars, taking/seizing opportunities, etc.

Continuous Learning Increases Your Earning Ability

Many young people ask me, *"I made a few thousand, what do I invest in?"* I usually give 2 straight answers: One, *"Why not invest in what created the few thousands in the first place; so, it will produce more few thousands?"* But if you achieved the thousands by a stroke of luck, then two, you need to invest in your financial education. Develop better selling, communication, relationship and leadership skills. Continuous learning increases your earning ability!

5. Referrals

If someone comes to me and wants to design a website, I can tell him to hold on. Then call a friend of mine who designs websites that I have a job for. Then ask for my percentage. And then link the two of them together. Finish! Once the deal is done, I collect my share! So, you qualified to be paid because you were the one who "made the deal happen"! This is the concept Network Marketing is based upon. Network Marketing is also called "Referral Marketing".

6. Start Your Own Network Marketing Business

Network marketing is a way in which a company sells its product directly to consumers through relationship referrals. The customer becomes the distributor. And it gives you the necessary education/personal development you need to be able to get even more results. It helps you to develop fantastic relationships as well.

7. Sell 10 Laws of Academic Excellence at 80%+ Profit

In case you didn't know, you can join others to earn from selling this book by going to…

> *http://bit.ly/f90percent*

Guardian Support

If your income is more than your expenses per month via financial support from your parents or guardian, fine! You can add the above to your streams of income only if you want to. Notice also that the real importance of the points above is to develop your capacity and not necessarily for the sake of money.

> *"If your **out**go is more than your **in**come, then your **up**keep will be your **down**fall." 😅 (anonymous)*

Notes

The 4 Basic Concepts – How to Master Anything

1. *Kevin Trudeau— "Your Wish is Your Command" Audio. 2008*

Chapter 1

1. *Jesus Christ—Luke 14:28*
2. *God—Isaiah 46:9—10*

Chapter 2

1. *Jesus Christ—Matthew 9:29*
2. *Jesus Christ—John 20:29*
3. *Jesus Christ—Mark 11:24*
4. *God—Psalm 16:3*
5. *David Schwartz— "The Magic of Thinking Big" (Audio Book).*
6. *Jesus Christ—Mathew 7:7—9*

Chapter 3

1. *Apostle Paul—2 Timothy 4:13*
2. *Festus—Acts 26:24*
3. *Mary, Mother of Jesus—John 2:5*

Chapter 4

1. *John C. Maxwell— "Failing Forward" (Book)*
2. *Dale Carnegie— "How to Win Friends and Influence People" (Book). 1934.*
3. *Jesus Christ—Matthew 6:34*
4. *Quote by Bishop David Oyedepo*

Chapter 6

1. *Jesus Christ—Luke 6:40 NLT*
2. *Apostle Paul—2 Thess. 3:6—12*
3. *Hebrews 5:14*

Chapter 7

1. *Jesus Christ—Matthew 7:7—9*

Chapter 8

1. *Robert Kiyosaki— "Increase Your Financial IQ" (Book). 2008.*

Chapter 9

1. *King Solomon—Proverbs 13:20 MSG*
2. *King Solomon—Proverbs 27:17*

Chapter 10

1. *King Solomon—Proverbs 12:24 NLT, James 3:2—5*
2. *King Solomon—Proverbs 18:21*
3. *King Solomon—Ecclesiastes 12:11 NLT*

Final Word

READ THIS BOOK AT LEAST 4 OR 30 TIMES. I DISCOVERED THAT the mind needs knowledge (or renewal) every day, even if it's the same knowledge. Just like our bodies feed on physical food every day, the spirit feeds on God's Word every day, our minds also need to feed on knowledge every single day. Even if it's the same knowledge.

I found that because I'm always changing, the same knowledge from the same book I've read many times **gives new understanding** each time I look at it again.

It suddenly appears like a brand-new book. So, if this book has genuinely helped you, do me a favour…

> *Promise yourself that you're going to read it over and over again until the spirit of the book enters into you. I predict that this will happen between your **4th & 30th** reading. By this time, you would have seen the results in your life & academics.*

Recommend and Bless Others with This Book!

When you do see results, kindly look around you and find about 50 people to bless with copies of this book or recommend it to them!

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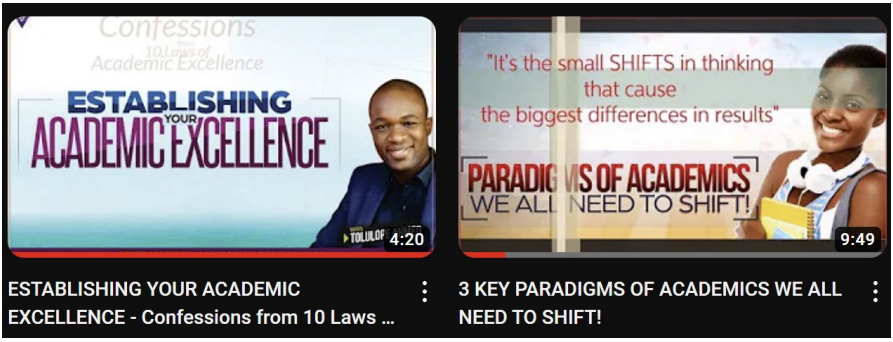


***YouTube**: http://youtube.com/tolulopeahmed*
***Audios:** http://hulkshare.com/tolulopeahmed*

Invite Us or Attend Our Seminars—*Books are just the beginning!*

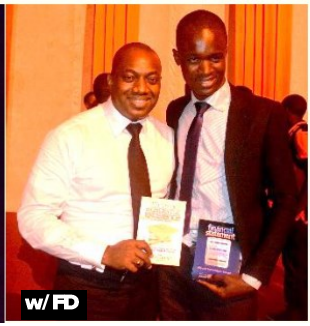
Academic Seminar, Roemichs International School, Ilorin, Kwara State, 2012

Project FAR (Finance, Academics, and Relationship), Amphi-theatre, Obafemi Awolowo University, Osun State, Nigeria. (Feb. 2014).

Snapshot from the Ministration at the NCCF State Conference, Ogun State, in 2018

Snapshot from Acada Conference at Obafemi Awolowo University, Ife, 2018.

Project FAR, 2014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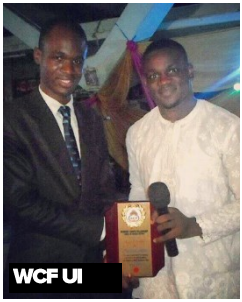
WCF UI

COVENANT UNIVERSITY SECONDARY SCHOOL, OTTA, 23rd March, 2015
With the little I and my classmate was able to read in your book really helped us in the just concluded JAMB.
Wow! Bless God. So what are your scores?
252, 234 and so on
And we are trusting God that since we have grapped from the book,, the post-JAMB will be higher than that
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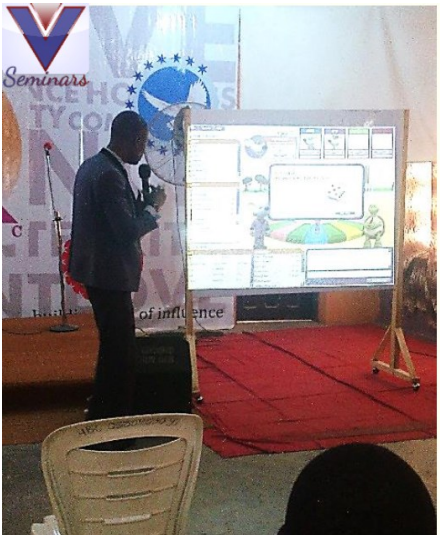

Teaching Financial & Business Intelligence using the Cashflow Game at JIO Business School, Ogbomoso, Oyo State, Nigeria, (January 2015)

Presenting Financial Intelligence at the 2020 TeenEX program at Ikorodu, Lagos

To have me minister at any of your events, email…

> *tolulopeahmed@gmail.com*

Other Materials

INTRODUCING...

1. **The A-Z of Publishing** — Learn the skill of publishing – from Inside Design to Cover Design to hard copy print and Amazon upload in this professional course.

2. **CONVERSION: How I Turned My Yearly into Monthly Income** — Learn the details of my story of how I went from a secondary school teacher to building a successful Publishing Company and a growing fintech platform.

   Buzz me directly on WhatsApp or visit http://bit.ly/f90percent to get it.

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